

**UNCERTAINTY:
YOUR SECRET
WEAPON**

The world around you – and your business – is filled with uncertainty. But within that uncertainty exist innumerable opportunities to design (or redesign) game-changing businesses. These opportunities are there for the taking, if you know how to look for them.

The world has changed. Not only are consumer habits, technologies, and other trends uprooting once-thriving businesses, entire markets are shifting and emerging out of the uncertainty and unpredictable nature of today's network economy. Interestingly (and infuriatingly to some), many of the companies leading the charge – and the change – did not exist two decades ago. It's not that these new players are just lucky or employ smarter, more capable people. So, how is it that they've found gold in some of the most unlikely places? In a word: design.

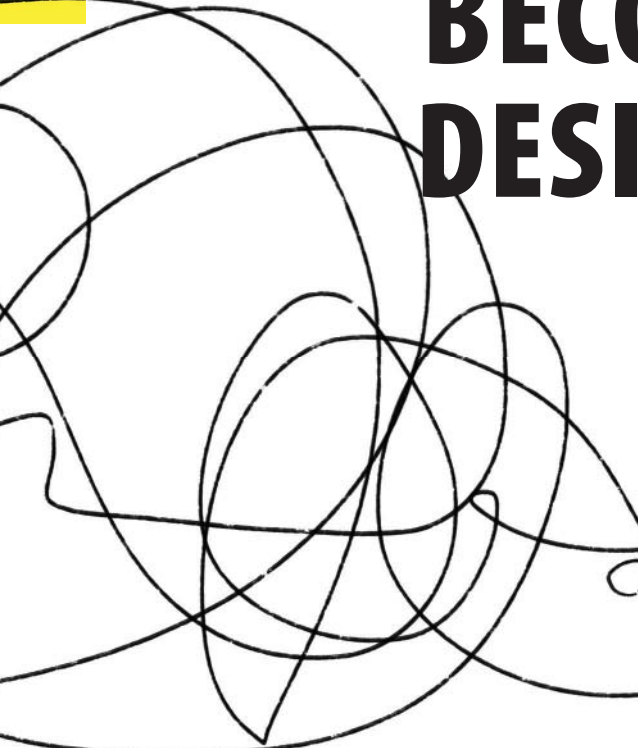
Design is fundamentally about enhancing the way you look at the world. It's a learnable, repeatable, disciplined process that anyone can use to create unique and qualified value. Design is not about throwing away the processes and tools you have. In fact, quite the opposite is true. Just as design has enabled countless upstarts to create new business models and markets, design will also help you decide when to use what tools in order to learn something new, persuade others to take a different course, and at the end of the day, make better (business) decisions.

Most of all, design is about creating the conditions by which businesses thrive, grow, and evolve in the face of uncertainty and change. As such, better businesses are ones that approach problems in a new, systematic way, focusing more

on doing rather than on planning and prediction. Better businesses marry design and strategy to harness opportunity in order to drive growth and change in a world that is uncertain and unpredictable.

This book will provide you with new tools, skills, and a mindset to harness opportunities born of uncertainty in order to design a better business. We've included tons of real-world examples of people who have mastered the fundamentals of design, as well as case studies of companies that have created change using design as the underlying foundation for decision making. And, just as design is a repeatable process, this book is meant not only to guide you on your design journey, but also to provide an ongoing reference to help you scale the design beyond one project or product to an entire company. ■

**YOU'VE GOT
EVERYTHING TO GAIN**

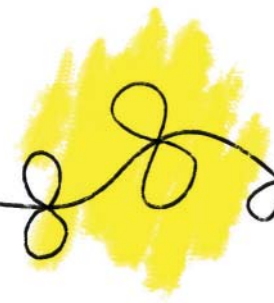


BECOME A DESIGNER

WHAT'S ALL THIS (DESIGN) BUZZ ABOUT

Design is quickly becoming one of those words like “innovation.” It has different meanings to different people. It can be a noun, an adjective, and a verb. Design is ultimately an empowering approach of looking at the world and igniting new possibilities to make it better.

Design is both a process and a mindset. It's an intentional set of practices to unlock new, sustainable value from change and uncertainty. It allows individuals and organizations to be more flexible and resilient in the face of constant change. Unfortunately, the flip



side of design is where we often find ourselves: scrambling when unforeseen change happens to us.

WITH GREAT POWER . . .

The good news is that you are already a designer, at least some of the time. Every time you intentionally develop strategy or make a decision based on insight, you are acting as a designer. The not-so-good news is that many of the tools that you have probably been using to help make those decisions are likely not as useful as they once were, at least not on their own. So, what do designers do and what tools do they use that help them make better decisions?

ITERATION

The key to design – and design tools – is that it is an **iterative** process by which designers, like you, start with a point of view, go out and observe the world to inform that point of view, create options that may address the opportunities you see, validate those options, and execute the ones that best address the opportunities. Most important, designers never focus on simply scaling the execution of the chosen option. Design is continuous and iterative; it's built to deal with ambiguity and change in a long-term way. ■

**DESIGN IS A DISCIPLINED APPROACH TO SEARCHING,
IDENTIFYING, AND CAPTURING VALUE.**

DESIGNER: A REBEL WITH A CAUSE

THE 7 ESSENTIAL SKILLS

IT ALL STARTS WITH **THE CUSTOMER.**

Observing customers to understand them will give you fresh insights into their needs. You must ask the right questions to get the answers you seek.

THINK AND WORK **VISUALLY!**

Working visually helps you to see the bigger picture, gain clarity on complex topics, create a visual anchor for your strategic conversations, and engage with your audience.

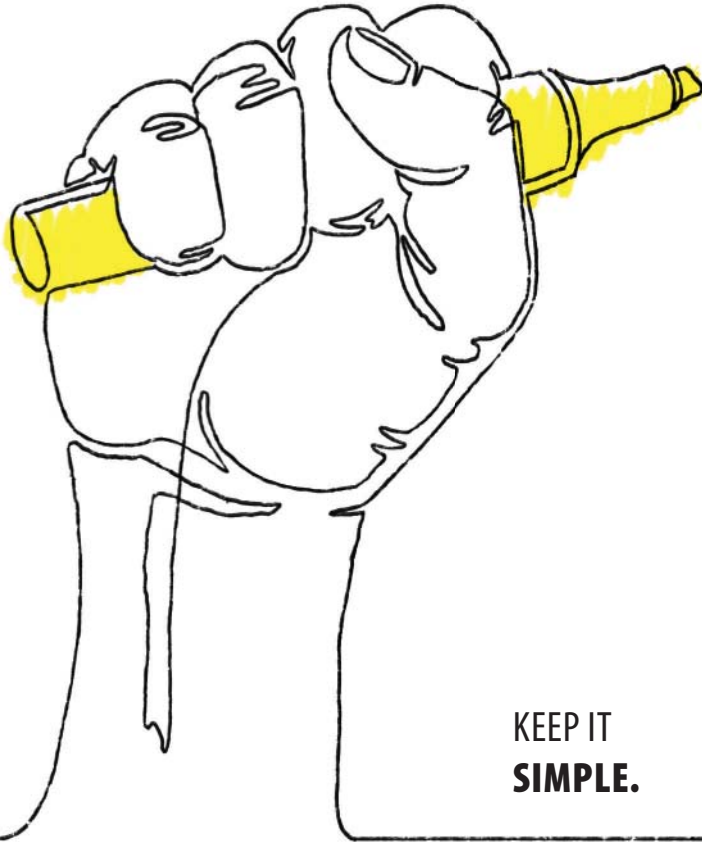
DON'T FLY SOLO.

YOU ARE NOT
SMARTER THAN
EVERYONE ELSE.

Gather different insights by working together. Connecting the brains in the room and in your market will enable you to uncover hidden opportunities.

TELL STORIES AND SHARE THE EXPERIENCE.

Stories have a clear beginning and end, and most likely they have heroes your audience can connect with. Cool stories stick. Cool stories will be told by others. Cool stories spread.



KEEP IT SIMPLE.

Just start. Don't try to build the final product. Don't add features that don't solve real problems.

SET UP SMALL EXPERIMENTS AND LEARN SHIT.

Every little iteration and trial will net tons of useful new insights – things you wouldn't have learned if you just started building. Reality is different than what you assume.

EMBRACE UNCERTAINTY. IT'S CANDY FOR THE BRAIN.

Except for change, there is no such thing as certainty in business. Accept this and harness opportunities from uncertainty.

DESIGN A BETTER

CONNECTING INNOVATION, BUSINESS, AND STRATEGY

So, now you're a designer who's been imbued with the goal of designing a better business. What does a better business look like? And, how would one go about designing a better business?

Many existing, established businesses, especially non-startup businesses, focus solely on getting products to market while reducing costs and increasing margins. In these businesses, strategy is executed in a linear way: prepare; execute. What's often missing in this story is the customer on the other side of the transaction, as well as the person designing and developing products and services to satisfy some need for the customer.



POINT OF VIEW P46

Designers, on the other hand, are always thinking about the customer. They approach people and problems from a particular perspective, one informed by design-specific tools like ideation, prototyping, and validation. They use human-centered tools, skills, and a mindset to search for, design, and execute new value propositions and business models based on what they've learned. Designers do this continually, iterating constantly to uncover opportunities within the fog of uncertainty.

BUSINESS

In this book, you'll find the designer's journey represented in a new way. Your point of view is at the center of the design process, which is always influenced and informed through understanding, ideation, prototyping, and validation. This process is iterative and cyclical.

So, what's a better business? A better business is one that puts the person at the center and connects design tools, practices, and processes.

To do this you must employ a design rigor – using your new tools, skills, and mindset – to guide business decisions and outcomes rather than solely driving day-to-day (business as usual) execution.

In doing so, your options for the future will become much clearer; as a designer, you will unequivocally begin to see opportunities within the fog of uncertainty.



UNDERSTAND P82



IDEATE P124



PROTOTYPE P152



VALIDATE P180

There's a continuous search for new customers, value propositions, and business models – with business execution and scale. As a designer, it's your job to make this connection. It's your job to consider and test new options for business sustainability and growth (by design). It's your job to consider the person you're designing for, which will inform your own unique point of view.

THE DOUBLE LOOP

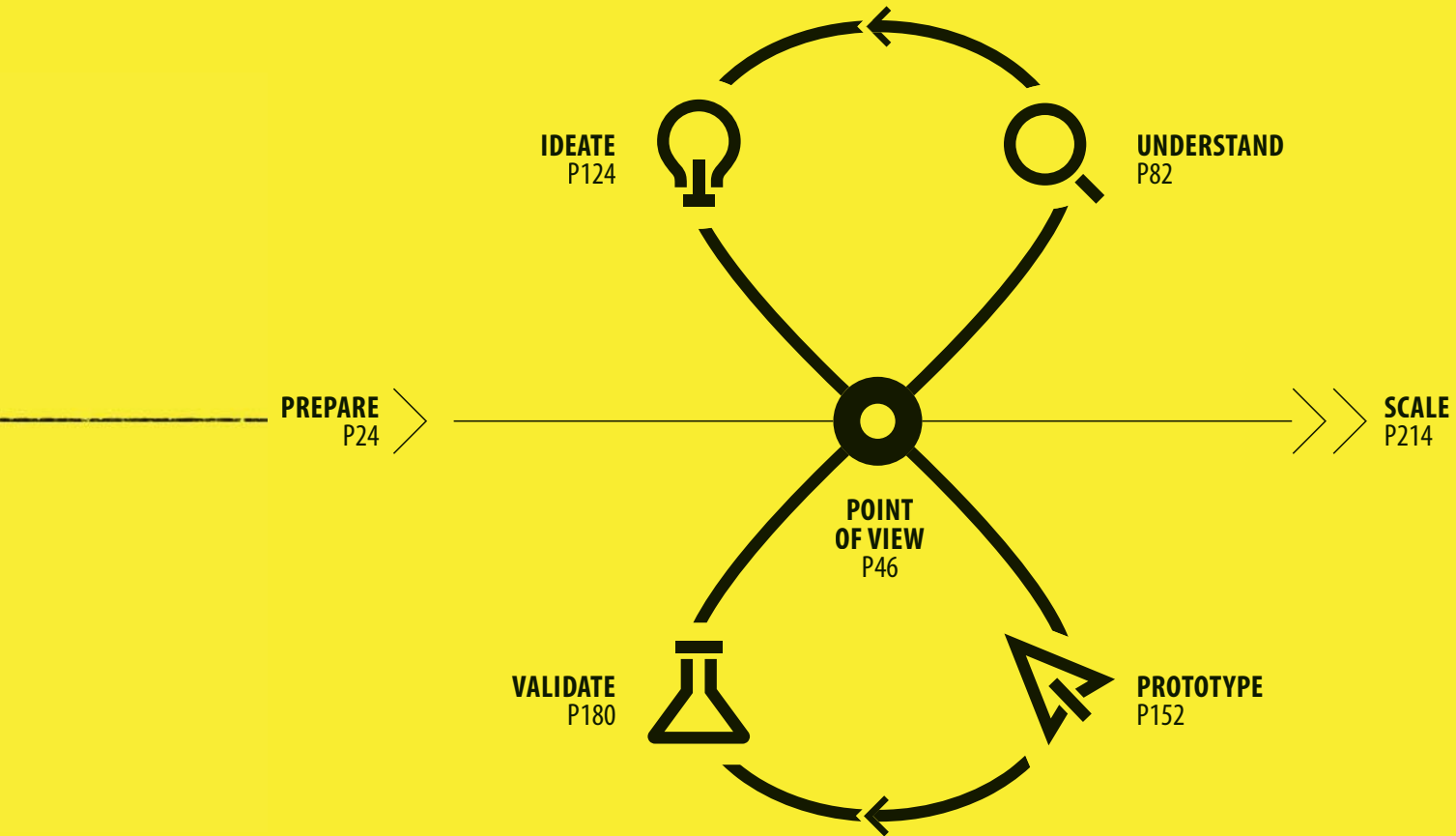
A DESIGN JOURNEY

The double loop is founded on a simple observation: every project, product, company, change, or idea starts with a point of view. It might be based on fact. It might be based on assumptions. Whatever your point of view, using it to create lasting change requires work and a movement toward the goal line.

The double loop takes your point of view into account, while adding rigor and continuity to the design process. This means that your point of view is always informed by understanding and that that understanding will spark new ideas, further enhancing your point of view. These ideas are prototyped and validated to test and measure their effectiveness. This, in turn, further informs your point of view and enables you to execute your ideas successfully.



Every design journey also has a beginning and . . . a goal. In the case of this design journey, the beginning starts with preparation, at the left of the design loop. Preparing yourself, your team, your environment, and the tools you'll use is essential for your successful journey. At the right of the design loop is the goal: scale. In this book, scale refers to two things. First, we talk about scaling the execution of your idea or change; this begins with your point of view. Second, we talk about scaling the design process. This is, after all, a book about designing better businesses. Design is at the core. And it is design that is meant to scale. ■



THE DOUBLE LOOP LANDSCAPE



POINT OF VIEW P46

Design is human. The journey you take will help to inform your point of view going forward.



UNDERSTAND P82

All design journeys start with the customer, context, and your business in mind. Understanding these is the key to designing something better.



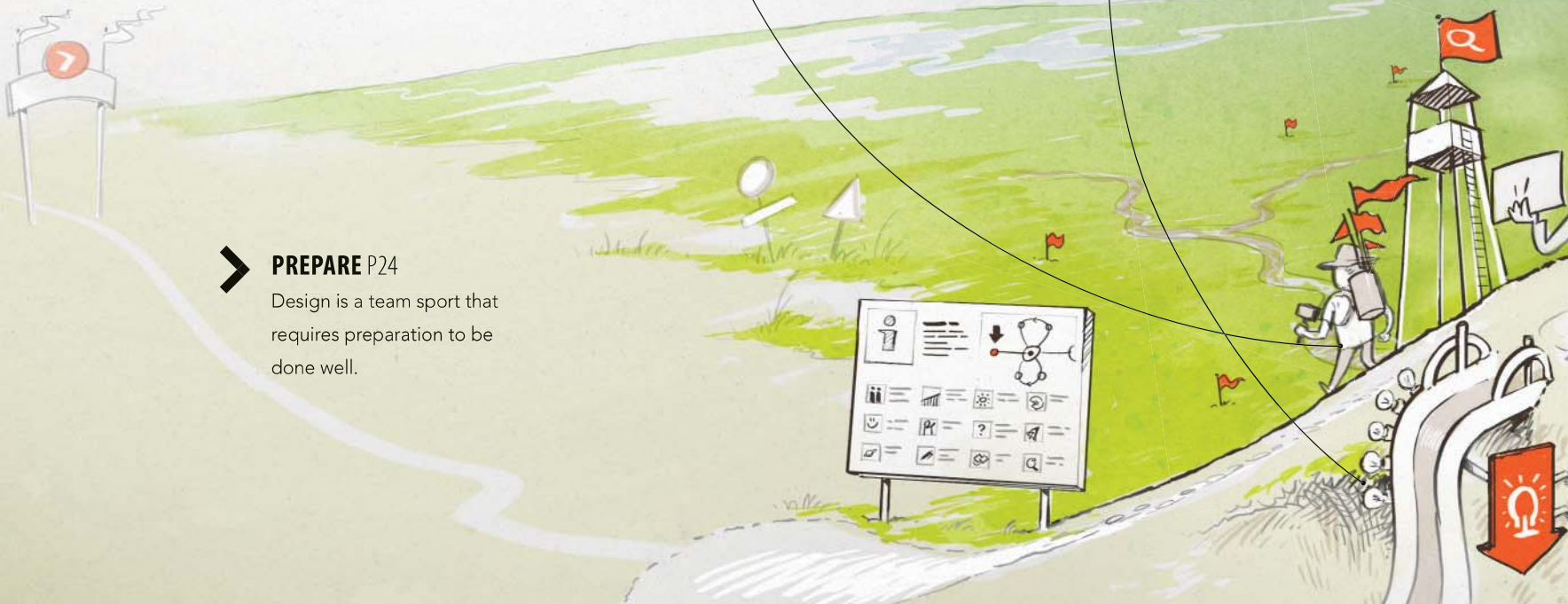
IDEATE P124

There is no single right solution. Ideation will enable you and your team to unlock and build upon each other's ideas.



PREPARE P24

Design is a team sport that requires preparation to be done well.



**SCALE** P214

Design journeys are iterative, cyclical, and designed to scale from small projects to organization-wide cultural norms.

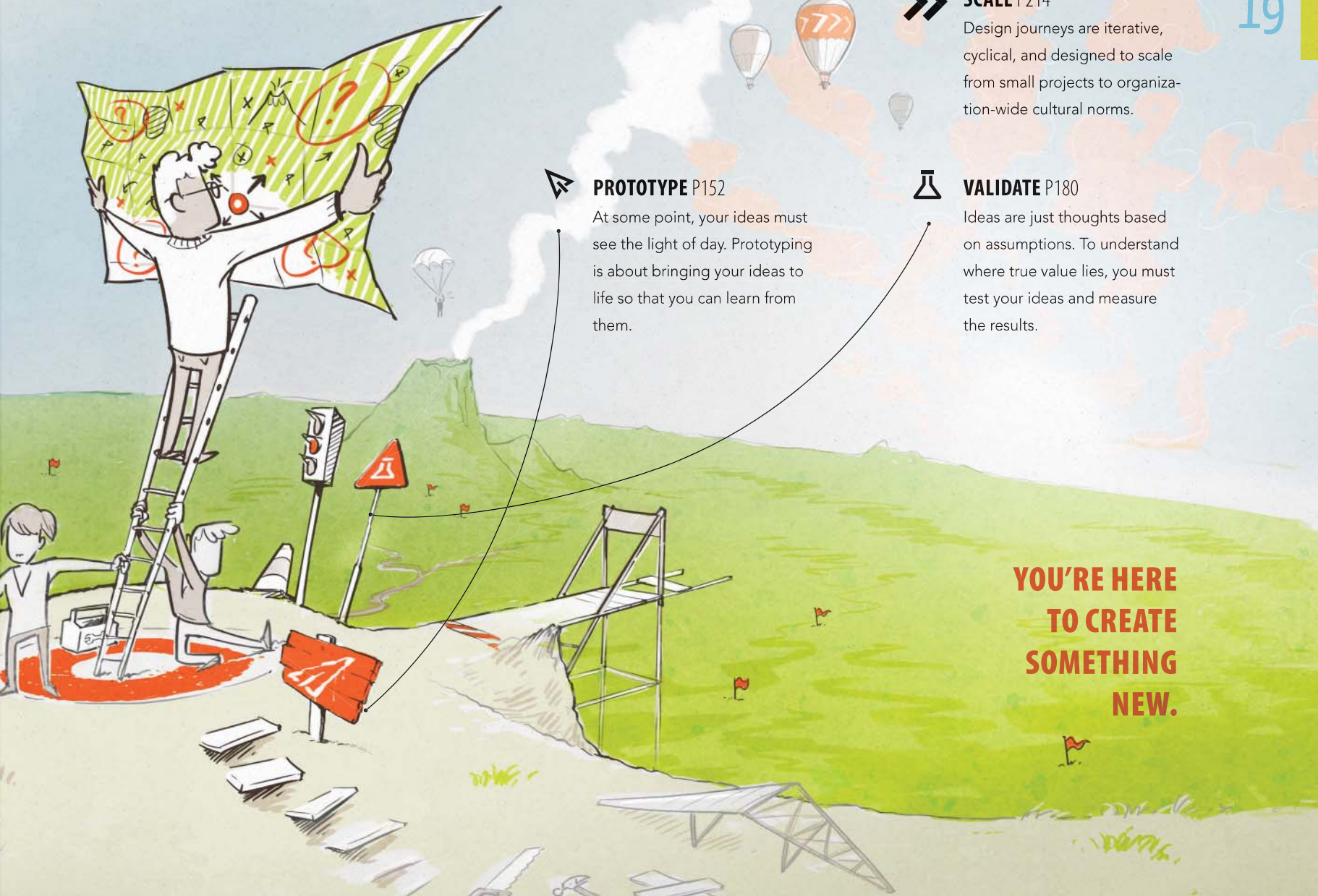
**PROTOTYPE** P152

At some point, your ideas must see the light of day. Prototyping is about bringing your ideas to life so that you can learn from them.

**VALIDATE** P180

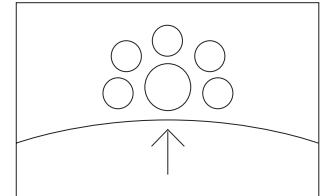
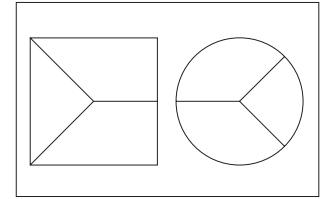
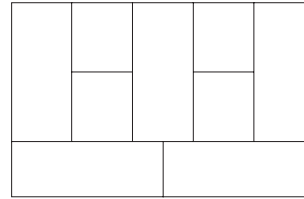
Ideas are just thoughts based on assumptions. To understand where true value lies, you must test your ideas and measure the results.

**YOU'RE HERE
TO CREATE
SOMETHING
NEW.**



YOUR TOOLS

As a designer, your first mission is simply to step out of the box you're in and observe the world and your customers in their natural states. Don't come at this with preconceived notions about what your customers are trying to achieve or how the world is ordered. Just watch and listen.



The first tool comes from skills we already possess – observation. When was the last time you stepped back and just watched and listened to your customers? Try it. We're sure you'll learn something new.

CREATING IMPACT

As you're watching and listening, start to look for patterns as well as interesting, unexpected actions, events, or occurrences. These create fodder for anecdotes that you can use to draw your manager or other team members into the human stories behind your products. If you've never used actual customer anecdotes and stories in a presentation, we can tell you that you're in for a great surprise.

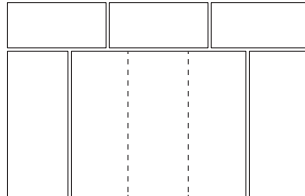
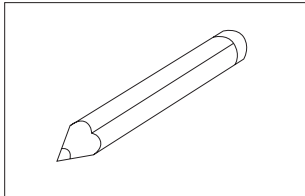
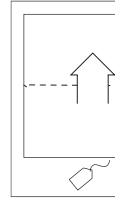
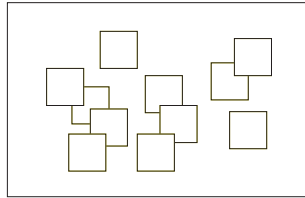
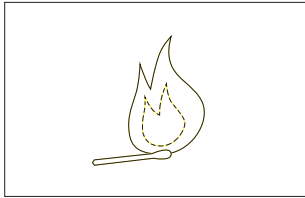
All people like stories and will be more interested and invested than they would if they were presented with only data. In fact, in the next chapter you'll find a tool specifically meant to help you design stories to deliver the impact you're looking for.

NOT OBSOLETE

As you become comfortable simply watching and listening to your customers, it's time to start using some new tools – design tools. Rest assured, you **do not** have to stop, nor should you stop using the tools that you're comfortable with. In fact, just as you cannot hope to change your company overnight, it's very unlikely you'll get everyone to believe your current tools are obsolete; and they're probably not. Instead, just as you might employ a new set of tools to work on a project at home, start to add a few new design tools to your belt (you wouldn't use a screwdriver to measure a wall, would you?!).

USEFUL DESIGN TOOLS

First, employ observational tools. These include tools that help you capture people's wants, needs, pains, and ambitions. You might also add to your belt tools for questioning and problem framing. After all, you can't expect to learn everything about your customers by simply watching them. Beyond observational tools, other design



tools include ideation tools, prototyping, and validation tools, as well as decision-making tools. These concepts might be quite familiar to other people on your team who have been designing for a while. But, no matter. We've included a variety of incredibly useful tools in this book to help you take business design to the next level.

GROW COMFORTABLE

As you become more comfortable using some of these tools, you'll no doubt notice that your old tools are becoming auxiliary or backups. You might even couple your old tools with your new (designer) tools to complement each other. For instance, you can use market data to bolster the anecdotes you gather in the field. Imagine the possibilities! The key here is that you start small and slowly develop mastery of the new tools and practices that at first may feel uncomfortable to wield. Don't worry, after you've used your designer tools a few times, they will become easier and more comfortable to use. And, through your new design-colored glasses, we are confident that you will begin to see the world in a whole new light. ■

THERE IS NO **TOOL CULTURE** (YET)

Where accountants, doctors, and surgeons are trained to use tools, business people are well trained for operations. They think they can innovate, but they lack the right skills and tools to do so.

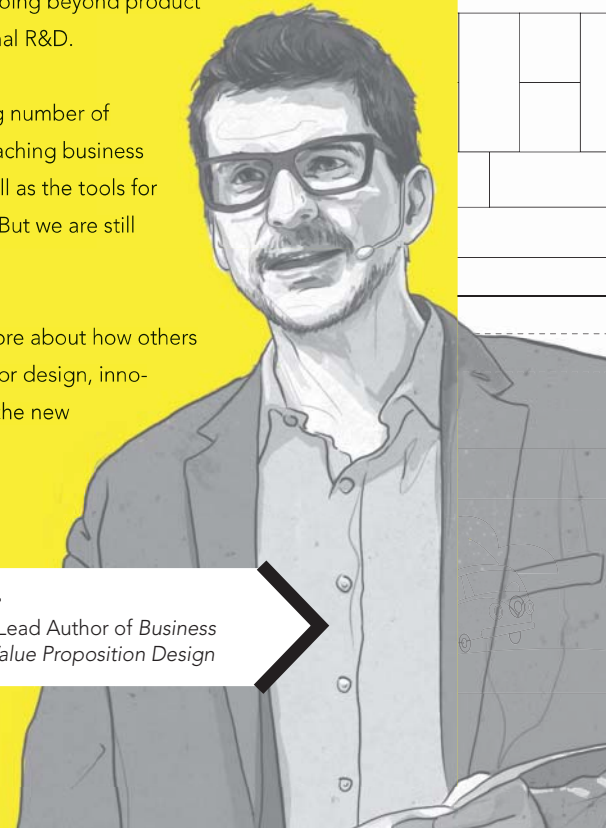
Whereas Apple and Amazon continuously reinvent their business models and are successful in doing so, other companies are helpless. Their traditional corporate structures conflict with design processes and innovation. It is in nobody's P&L so they just don't care. Sure, companies innovate their products. But they have a hard time going beyond product innovation and traditional R&D.

Nowadays an increasing number of business schools are teaching business model innovation as well as the tools for design and innovation. But we are still very much at the start.

I am excited to learn more about how others develop and use tools for design, innovation, and strategy as the new drivers of business.

Alexander Osterwalder

Co-founder Strategyzer, Lead Author of *Business Model Generation* and *Value Proposition Design*



FAST PASSES

WANT QUICK ANSWERS?

We have provided you with some fast tracks so you don't have to stand in line waiting for your future. These fast tracks will guide you to the relevant tools, skills, or case studies. Learn from the experience of others and apply it now.

FLIGHT NO.
BM 1106 03.21

START BOARDING
GATE

SEAT NO.

FAST-FREQUENT FLYER

I WANT TO DESIGN A STRATEGY

I need a plan of action to take my team to
our desired future state.

STEPS:

- » Understand your current business model(s) and understand your customers by observing and asking questions
- » Develop a point of view by creating your 5 Bold Steps Vision® and transforming your vision into a story and seeing if it resonates
- » Ideate new business model options
- » Prototype new value propositions

PAGES:

86

58

142

152

FLIGHT NO.
BM 1106 03.21

START BOARDING
GATE

SEAT NO.

BOARDING PASS - FAST-FREQUENT FLYER

I WANT TO DO BUSINESS PLANNING

I want to move beyond spreadsheets and
explore business planning with my team.

STEPS:

- » Map the current context you operate in
- » Understand your current business model
- » Understand your (future) customers
- » Revisit your company's vision
- » Design future business model options
- » Propose ideas to prototype

PAGES:

110

114

98

56

142

152

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BOARDING

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I WANT A STRONG & SHARABLE VISION

I want to develop a **North Star** with my team so we know where we are headed.

STEPS:	PAGES:
>> Develop your point of view and make a Cover Story vision® with your team	64
>> Validate your cover story in- and outside your company	180

I WANT TO CREATE A SWOT OF MY BUSINESS

What are the **strengths, weaknesses, opportunities, and threats** for my business?

STEPS:	PAGES:
>> Understand the context of your business	110
>> Understand your business model(s)	86
>> Determine strengths and weaknesses	116

• UNIQUE OFFERING! -FAST PASS-

I WANT TO INNOVATE /GROW MY BUSINESS

There are no shortcuts, but we do provide you with some fast tracks so you don't have to stand in line waiting for your future.

STEPS:	PAGES:
>> Do the Double Loop	16

I WANT TO WORK AS A STARTUP

Here's how you can work lean and mean when you want to bring your idea to market.
Learn from startups.

STEPS:	PAGES:
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>> Understand: observe and ask questions (!)	86
>> Ideate your business model options	142
>> Sketch a low- and high-fidelity prototype	172
>> Validate, validate, validate	180
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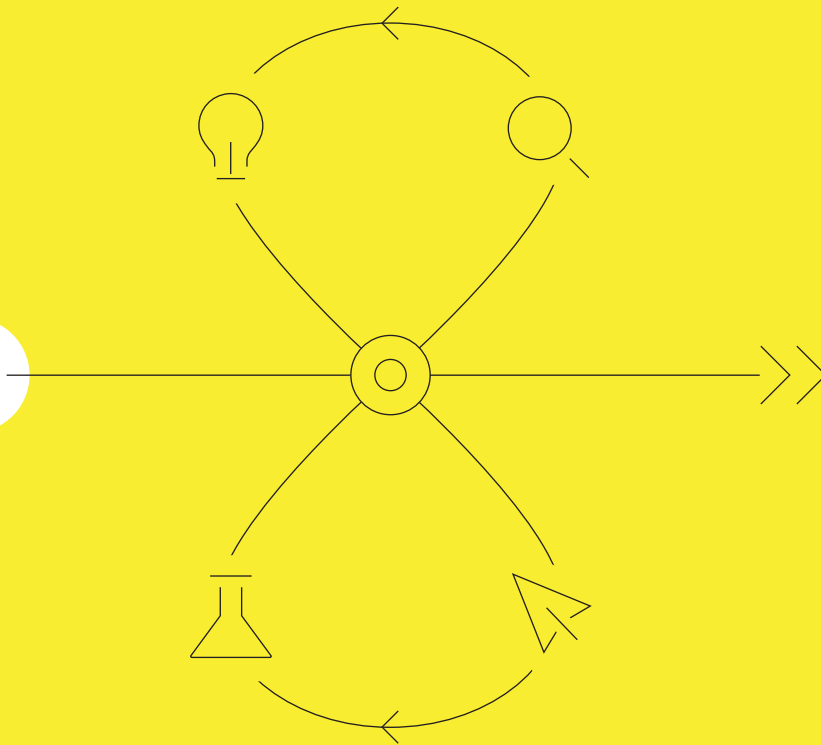
CHEAP AND FAST



USE A
FAST PASS
OR PREPARE
FOR A FULL
JOURNEY



PREPARE



THE DESIGN JOURNEY **PREPARE**

PREPARE YOUR **TEAM**

PREPARE YOUR **ENVIRONMENT**

PREPARE **HOW YOU WORK**

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EVERY JOURNEY STARTS WITH **PREPARATION**

Whether you're about to go on a journey of exploration to understand your customer or design new business models for your future, preparation is key. You wouldn't go into battle without preparing first. Likewise, you'll need to prepare before launching a design (or redesign) initiative.

DESIGN IS ABOUT PREPARATION

The design process requires preparation in order for it to run well. You must prepare to observe and understand your customers, business, and context. You must prepare to ideate, prototype, and validate. What this boils down to is that to set yourself and your team up for success, you must prepare your team for the journey ahead, prepare your environment for the work that will ensue, and prepare your tools so that you'll get the best results from everyone.

SET YOURSELF UP FOR SUCCESS

The design process may be different from many of the other processes you're used to. For one, it is not really linear; it's cyclical and iterative. It's about embracing uncertainty. Not everything can be planned or controlled. It is also a full-contact team sport. Teams that take the time to prepare often enjoy much better results and outcomes. Design also requires physical space to work in. And not just people hunched over computers. The people designing the better business will need space to ideate, prototype,

and validate. It also requires that you employ new tools, which also necessitate preparation in order to achieve the best results. Last but not least, design requires that you get used to a new way of working and a new project structure. It's not about planning. It's about maximizing the chance of a positive outcome and empowering others to make real change. There are things you can control and things you can't. **Set yourself and your team up for success by controlling what you can;** don't leave things up to chance.

PREPARE YOUR TEAM

Babe Ruth, the famous American baseball player, once said, "The way a team plays as a whole determines its success. You may have the greatest bunch of individual stars in the world, but if they don't play together, the club won't be worth a dime." The same can be said about designing great businesses: the best businesses are the products of great teams.

That said, not just any team will do. A team that will generate the most useful ideas from its key findings, and that will most

TIP! Not just any team will do. The people on your design team must want to be there. Otherwise, they'll push for business as usual.

thoroughly prototype and validate those ideas, is made up of a diverse group of unusual suspects (think the *A-Team*, not *Friends*). They will find diamonds in the rough where no one else has. They will challenge each other. And, by virtue of their diversity, they will bring with them a network of other people and resources that will come in handy when it's time to get down and dirty.

SEARCH FOR THE REBEL

When it comes to big hairy questions or initiatives, most of us are unwilling to take a leap and try something new to achieve the outcome we dream of. In order to do this, we need a rebel. A rebel is someone who is willing to stand up and announce that the time has come to take a new approach to solving a problem or answering a question. This person has the ability to carve out time and broker for resources for the design journey. The rebel is the one who will persist and ensure that you're able to try something new before going back to the old way of doing things.

PREPARE YOUR ENVIRONMENT, YOUR SPACE

By now you're aware that design is not linear. It is an iterative process in which you will constantly need to refer to artifacts that have been developed along the way. Carting these around the office and sticking them on different walls every other day not only is it a pain in the neck, but it also reduces the time you have to actually design. This reduces overall productivity. Having a "war room" where the team can get together and see progress will boost productivity and efficiency tremendously.

PREPARE HOW YOU WORK (TOGETHER)

Tools like the screenplay – introduced later in this chapter – will help you design your meetings (or design sprints) to maximize your time together. Visual artifacts like the customer journey and Business Model Canvas will help your team hold more focused strategic conversations. Taking the time to think through how you'll use these tools will help you maximize their value. It's not hard work – but it's essential. »

EVERY JOURNEY STARTS WITH **PREPARATION**

SO, WHERE SHOULD YOU START?

Think big, but be willing to start small! Most people approach big projects and new processes by seeking commitment from the board or an executive committee. This is fine and may work in some cases. Design doesn't require a certain outcome. Instead, it's about the journey, the findings you obtain along the way, and the options you generate and validate. With that in mind, here are some ways others have started their design journeys.

WITH THAT IN MIND, HERE ARE SOME WAYS OTHERS HAVE STARTED THEIR DESIGN JOURNEYS.

Of course, you could also start big and go straight to the board. If you decide to take that route, ask for a budget to train your team in design thinking for strategy and innovation. Whether or not there is an appetite for design in your organization, your colleagues will certainly develop skills and take journeys that deliver better business results, however small or incremental.

1 FIND YOUR SPARK

Change starts with a spark. Something in the world shifts, and someone reacts to that shift. Whether it's for yourself or your company, to start your design journey, you'll need a reason to take the journey in the first place.

2 FIND AMBASSADORS

Business as usual doesn't leave much room for design process if you don't have ambassadors on your side. Socialize your idea with a few potential ambassadors. If you get them on board, your journey will be a whole lot smoother.

3 RECRUIT THE RIGHT TEAM

Design is not a journey to be taken alone. Success in design comes when a team of people are in it together and are collectively compelled to see the process through. You'll need varying points of view, skills, and a good network to tap into. Build your team with this in mind and you can't go wrong.

4 RAISE ALL BOATS

Organize a targeted (not generic) training course or bring in a thought leader to help ignite interest in business model innovation or strategy design.

FIND YOUR **AMBASSADORS**

Preparing for a small team is one thing. Preparing for a large company is quite another.

So how do you best prepare for an innovation journey as an established company? We asked organizations like 3M, Lufthansa, SAP, ING Bank, MasterCard, GE, Philips, and Toyota how they have been nurturing and supporting cultures of innovation and design thinking. They shared their findings during a summit in New York, February 2015.

Their biggest takeaway: in order to prepare for innovation and design thinking, it is an absolute must that companies identify champion users of design tools, such as the Business Model Canvas, the vision canvas, and other human-centered tools. The champions, or ambassadors, must be proficient in the “lean” approach to design and development and carry with them a designer’s mindset at all times. No problem is too big or too small for these ambassadors.

When your goal is to scale design throughout your organization, it’s essential to find and train more than one ambassador. In fact, you’ll need to create an army of ambassadors who are familiar with and passionate about the new ways of working. They need to adopt and help spread design approaches to business by doing more than they talk. ■

Courses and master classes are great ways to learn new ways of working while becoming familiar with a new set of tools, skills, and mindsets. Oftentimes you’ll learn about other organizations that have employed design successfully. Use this insight to evaluate where and how you might further introduce design into your organization.

5 DESIGN WORKSHOP

Organize a design workshop focused on business model innovation or strategy to immerse yourself in the design process and determine where the goal is for you and your team to co-create a concrete deliverable. This could be the design of a vision, a business model, or a value proposition for a new concept.

6 FIND THE STRAGGLERS

Pick one of your existing products or services that’s struggling to generate revenue (or profit). Run a workshop with a diverse team to generate new business model ideas.

7 GET OUT OF THE BUILDING

Get out of the building and talk to customers to understand what matters to them. What do they say? What do they think? Present your findings to others in your organization. ■

PREPARE YOUR **TEAM**



You won't win a soccer match with 11 strikers or a football match with only quarterbacks. The same holds for business. Whether you're trying to win in sports or in business, it's crucial to employ players with varying skills (and superpowers) – the team needs to be multidisciplinary.



Don't forget to have fun together! Hey! Who brought the drone to the party?!

Unusual suspects: that new graduate you just hired; a high-energy up-and-comer; or someone young, with interesting ideas, that you think of as an idealist.

Sales and marketing gurus who know the customer.

BUILD A MULTIDISCIPLINARY TEAM

The ideal team will be able to cover a wide range of tasks. Need someone to write a proposal? Add that person to the team. How about someone to design a pitch deck? And maybe we need a coder . . . You get the picture.

The more viewpoints the team brings to the table, the more options that team will be able to generate. There is no one single right solution in any design, business or otherwise.

FIND THE UNUSUAL SUSPECTS

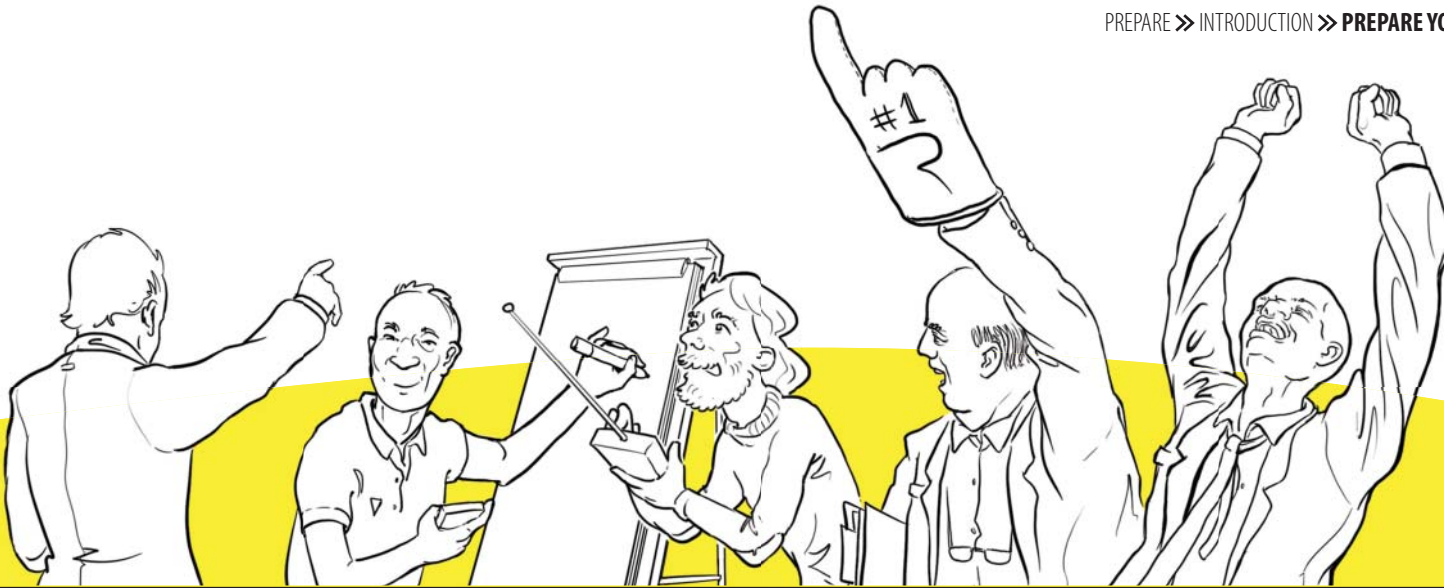
If every team member has the same exact life experiences, skills, knowledge, and viewpoints, the range of options they will zero

in on is incredibly narrow. To avoid that, intentionally design your team to include people from different departments – and with different skills levels, backgrounds, cultures, and mindsets.

ROLES: IT'S NOT ON YOUR BUSINESS CARD

When you look at a business card, what do you see under the name of the person? Likely a title, and that title is very likely not that person's role.

Roles describe the responsibilities that someone takes on, either formally or informally, as part of the team. They play a central part in getting things done. Roles, not titles, are critical to your success. It is important that each team member take ownership



A strategist or product manager who always has the North Star in mind.

Kickass visual facilitators to drive the project forward, harnessing all of the energy.

Lateral thinkers, mavericks and rebels, hackers, developers, and designers.

An executive sponsor takes responsibility when things get tough.

Ambassadors and fans to increase engagement.

of the design, both while working on the design and when it comes to pitching ideas to other stakeholders. Designing the right roles helps team members understand how and where they can best contribute to the end result. The roles people play on your design team will vary from ambassadors to sales, and from visual thinkers to engineers.

Just as you'll intentionally design who's on the team, you also need to design the roles people play on that team. When your team doesn't know the plays, you can't score a touchdown.

WHEN TO ASSEMBLE A TEAM

When considering your design team, it's essential that you assemble the right people, with the right attitudes, at the right

time. You'll need this team for design workshops, brainstorming, and fieldwork: when you need to get out of the office to understand what your customers want, need, and do. You'll need to assemble a team to design and produce prototypes.

Unlike in most corporate settings, do not assemble a team for a project or to simply join meetings or discussions. Do not assemble a team to engage in planning if that same team is not going to engage in the design process. Do not assemble a team for project communication; that's what the facilitator is for. Your design team's goal is to do and make and learn and deliver results. ■

PREPARE YOUR **ENVIRONMENT**

Design is not business as usual. The spaces your team designs in must be able to handle a new way of working.

A SPACE FOR PEOPLE

If design is a contact sport, then the environments you play in must be able to handle the frequent interactions of the team. Design isn't about meeting, sitting, talking, and leaving the meeting to go back to email. It's about standing, interacting, writing on sticky notes, going outside, crunching numbers together, and assembling to update each other before doing it again.

The best design environments take into account how people interact – not just while they're seated, but also while they're standing, evaluating a canvas on the wall. These environments leave space for working together and presenting concepts. The best design environments are dedicated for a specific project, so that all of the design artifacts can be left as is, enabling the team to quickly track its progress.

HOME BASE

However you prepare for your environment, your goal is to create a home base where your team can be creative, soak in the information, and have meaningful discussions about it. When-

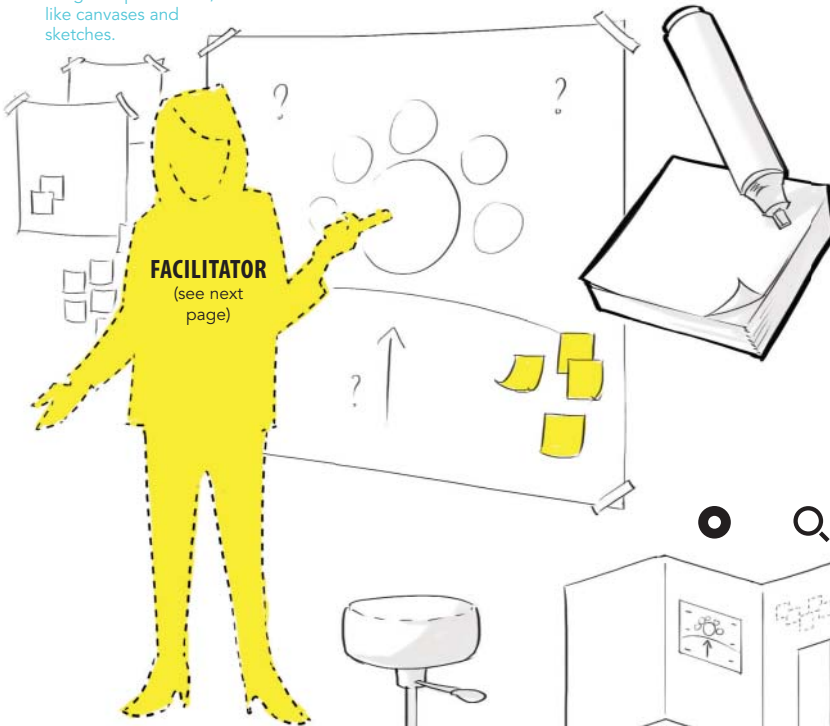
A PLACE TO HUDDLE
There should be places to huddle in order to think through and discuss new ideas.



GET ENOUGH SPACE
Does the room have the capacity to hold your entire team comfortably while sitting as well as moving around?

WALL SPACE

Any design environment must have ample wall space to hang or tape artifacts, like canvases and sketches.



TOOLS

Do you have all of the necessary tools for design: sticky notes, paper, markers, canvases, etc.?

KEEP IT UP

Ideally, your artifacts should be left in the room during your project.

SHOPPING LIST

BEANBAG - CHECK OUT FATBOY
UNUSUAL FURNITURE - CHECK STEELCASE

TAPE - MAKE SURE YOUR WALLS DON'T COME OFF

MARKERS - FOR YOUR MARKER SNIFFING HIPPIES

STICKY NOTES - GET THE RIGHT BRAND SO THEY DON'T FALL DOWN (WWW.3M.COM)

FLIP CHARTS OR LARGE-FORMAT PAPER

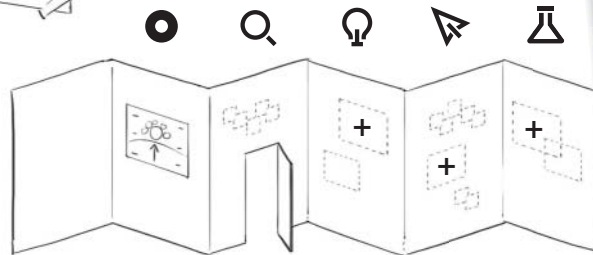
LARGE-FORMAT CANVASES

GRAPHIC OR FLEXIBLE WALLS - CHECK OUT THESE GUYS (WWW.NEULAND.COM)

MAKE SURE A COFFEE MACHINE OR FRIDGE IS CLOSE BY!

VERSATILE FURNITURE

You must be able to rearrange the tables and chairs in the room to facilitate different modes of working.



As you move along your design journey, your war room (should) be the heart of the progression.

ever possible, design a war room: a physical space in your company where people can meet, work, and see the progress visually. Alternatively, you can design temporary, popup spaces that can be rolled into and out of rooms efficiently. You will see the team start to work and think differently. ■



MASTER FACILITATION

The design journey is all about preparation, and it's the facilitator's job to make that preparation and the journey ahead easy for everyone involved. A skilled facilitator is the master of ceremonies as well as the keeper of the light – the energy and intentionality in the room. It is up to the facilitator to help the team achieve the outcomes expected efficiently and effectively.

—Emmanuel Buttin Business Line CFO, BNP Paribas

MASTER OF CEREMONIES

A facilitator (you or someone else) must run meetings according to a screenplay while also providing space for the team to discuss and make decisions along the way, always being cognizant of the time (and need for frequent breaks, coffee, and food). The facilitator must also capture (or elect a scribe to capture) salient points of view, ideas, and decision points along the way.

Of course, there are many ways to do this. Using a whiteboard, chalkboard, or large flip charts, you can capture short bullet points about what's been said.

BECOMING A FACILITATOR

If you want to run a design process on strategy and innovation smoothly, engage with your team members, and develop leadership opportunities, you need facilitator skills. The more you know about how to design and run a good learning process, the more team members will feel empowered about their own ideas and participation. They will take on ownership and responsibility, resulting in better outcomes.

1 LEARN TO MANAGE ENERGY

Facilitation is first and foremost about managing energy. To maximize output, the team must feel energized. “Energy,” in this case, describes how willing and able people are to contribute. “Good” energy helps the process. A discussion at the right time does just that. But hold a discussion at the wrong time, and exhaustion will quickly set in. The core skill of the facilitator is to manage the balance between going into the weeds and building energy.

2 IT'S MORE THAN JUST THE MEETING

Facilitation isn't about simply facilitating a discussion or a meeting; it's about facilitating the whole process. You'll need to become the mastermind of the operation. It's not about being right; it's about being effective in how you help teams by designing and managing the process. Facilitation is about the environment, information, the network, the team, and the energy. This includes communicating each step the team will take, as well as the promises made.

DOING THE DISHES

In a meeting you have two types of people: the ones with “focused eyes” and the ones with “absent eyes”; business people versus designers. They play different roles in a meeting, but both are indispensable in a team.

The former are often misjudged to be shortsighted and judgmental, when they are actually taking things at face value (by nature). They give their opinions freely and have quick answers to everything. The latter’s glazed-over looks are certainly not signs of disinterest. In their heads they are building on ideas and visualizing opportunities before speaking out.

From an outsider’s perspective, it’s hard to see how these people can work together effectively. In fact, you need both kinds of people on a team: fast movers and thinkers. It is my job to bridge those two worlds: Make them combine their brain-power and get them to share the same vision. When I see these situations arising, I offer a spark (or fire starter) to help steer them in the right direction. Then I step out to do the dishes while they perform miracles together.

Markus Auerbach
Director, Audi Innovation Research



3 WEAR THE RIGHT HAT AT THE RIGHT TIME

There are times to be utterly optimistic and there are times to be critical. For instance, as ideation is about idea creation and expansion 90% of the time and evaluation and selection 10% of the time, it’s vital that everyone on the team is wearing their optimistic hat at least 90% of the time, during idea creation.

But when it’s time for evaluation and selection, it’s okay for everyone to put on their critical hats. And in both cases, it’s the job of the facilitator to ensure that optimism and criticality are employed at the right place and time in the journey.

4 VISUAL FACILITATION

The spoken word is intangible. What has been said five minutes ago only exists in memory. This prompts participants to repeat their argument over and over again.

David Sibbet, the pioneer of visual facilitation, found that by capturing the arguments on a big flip chart, big enough for all the participants to read, the need for repetition vanishes. Take a marker and write down what has been said, to allow the discussion to move on. ■

MANAGING ENERGY

TIME MANAGEMENT

As with any process, the design process is deliberately designed with time in mind. When you're aiming for a goal, you're doing so with an eye on a specific date and time; you wouldn't ideate or validate forever. As a facilitator, it's your job to manage the timing of the process.

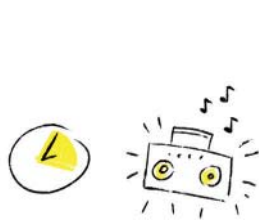
To keep everyone on the same page when you're working together, create an agenda using a flip chart and big permanent markers, and stick (or tape) it to the wall. Keep to the times and don't skip any breaks. You'll find that as people get more used to this structure, they'll deliver better results together.

DETAIL VS. OVERVIEW

While there are always big thinkers and strategic thinkers in groups, most often, the same people who think big and strategic thoughts are also stuck in the proverbial mud of the current operational execution engine. Of course, it's important to have people like this on board. But, this often becomes a challenge for the facilitator to steer the team forward into the expansive waters of strategic options.

This is especially true in big companies, where a constant balance exists between "let's move to action" and "let's make sure we are acting on the right things." This requires the facilitator

TIP! USE PUSH AND PULL TO MANAGE ENERGY



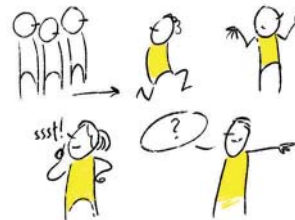
TIME MANAGEMENT

The best trick for time management is to put the participants in charge of keeping time. They'll start to work toward being efficient.



PUSH

Actions that push: moving into the group, putting words into people's mouths, making the group jump through formal hoops and structures, and arguing.



PULL

Actions that pull: taking a step back, not immediately having an answer, being silent, and asking honest, open questions.



HOLDING THE MARKER

Holding the marker means you have the power to frame the discussion and to move on – the arguments are recorded and need not be repeated.

and the participants to be able to bounce quickly between the big picture and the detail. This is one reason securing a core team, agreeing to a charter, and being transparent throughout the design process are so important. This is where the real facilitation takes place!

MAKE IT VISUAL

We humans are visual, spatial creatures. To really have an impact and sum up discussions and decision points so that they'll be remembered forever, do what David Sibbet says, and capture what's been said (at least some of it) visually.

The saying “a picture is worth a thousand words” was never truer than when you're trying to record and replay important context from a meeting or design sprint. An added bonus of holding the pen is that it will help you keep the center of attention on the whiteboard, flip chart or wall.

Furthermore, simply reviewing images allows you to replay entire conversations with nary a written word on the page. Whatever you decide, what's important here is that you capture the moments and decisions that lead to outcomes. ■



For more information on visual facilitation, read:
Visual Meetings by David Sibbet

IT'S LIKE JAZZ

David Sibbet says visual facilitation is like jazz, playing within steady beats and formal structures that empower spontaneity and vitality.

Like live jazz, spoken words flow on. In meetings this often prompts repetition and hopes for real listening. Sibbet finds that capturing these words on large charts acknowledges the listening. The need to repeat diminishes. And a group memory is created. This frees the discussion to move to new levels.

Sibbet is one of the pioneers in visual facilitation, and practiced and taught in this space in the 1970s, when he started The Grove. Visual facilitation is a key to inspiring and engaging groups, supporting big-picture thinking, and the enacting what comes from having a group memory.

Some of his tools, such as the Cover Story Vision Graphic Guide® and the Context Map Graphic Guide®, are featured in this book.

David Sibbet

Author, Founder, and Chairman of
The Grove Consultants International



PREPARE **HOW YOU WORK** (TOGETHER)

You've put together a team and secured an environment to work together in. Now it's time to actually work together, efficiently and effectively. To achieve the best results as a team while continually staying on the same page, you'll need some design tools.

THE DESIGNER'S ESSENTIALS

There's a very good reason designers and creative types carry around sticky notes and big permanent markers. Sticky notes are expendable, additive, stick to anything, and have the added value of being constrained by size, while permanent markers are, well, permanent, and make what's represented on each sticky note more readable. Hand stacks of each of these tools to everyone and let the ideas fly. By the end of the day you should have a wall of ideas and a floor piled high with half-starts. You get bonus points for getting everyone to draw their points of view (visually) on sticky notes. For some simple sketching tips, check out the profile on Dan Roam, in the prototyping chapter.

FRAME DISCUSSIONS USING A CANVAS

In just about every chapter of this book you'll find canvases, like the Business Model Canvas, Value Proposition Canvas, as well as others that can be used for visioning, storytelling, validating, etc. These visual artifacts will help spark interesting conversations while framing the ensuing discussions.

These tools are not tools to be filled out and put away. As essential design tools, the canvases provided here are also living,

breathing records that document your design journey. When you pair people, sticky notes, markers, and sketching, not only will the design process be faster and easier, you'll get much better results and learn to speak in a new shared language.

BETTER MEETINGS VIA SCREENPLAYS

Meetings have become a (bad) habit for most large organizations. In fact, this habit extends to the way we work: we sit behind our desk working independently from others. We send lots of email. We make a few phone calls. And when we're not sitting at our desks, we're in meetings.

Meetings are not necessarily bad, but more often than not, they are simply planned – not designed. In turn, nothing really happens at the meetings we show up to. There is no clear structure. What's the purpose of this meeting? Who is in the room? How do we make sure we get things done in this time slot? How do we know what is expected from us in this meeting? Those questions rarely get asked – and all the while, we have rooms full of people wasting time, resources, and energy.

IMPROVISE LIKE A **CHAMP**

TIP! Have a walking meeting. When walking or standing up, not only is the body more mobile, but so is the mind. It is much harder to become entrenched in an argument when you are mobile.

What's more, using meetings to share information is also a waste of time. Meetings are more often social and political. We feel badly if we exclude colleagues when sending invites for a meeting. Instead of thinking about who are the right people to be in the room, we think about who we don't want to exclude. Not having the right people in the room – or having too many people in the room – leads to slow progress. This wastes everyone's time.

The key to good meetings – and even better workshops – is to create a screenplay. Not to be confused with an agenda, a screenplay details who will work on what when. Most notably, it will help you design a meeting based on the results you wish to achieve. ■

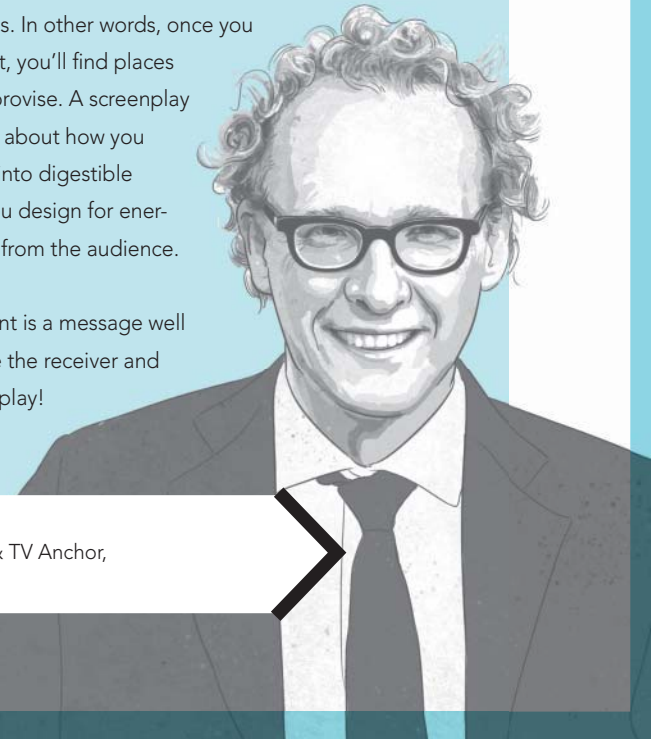
After I speak on stage or appear on television and radio shows, people often approach me and say, "You make it look so easy, as if you improvise on the spot! How do you do that?"

The answer is simple. It takes time. I invest a lot of time in my screenplay. Why? You are responsible for designing the flow of an event. When you go through it step by step, you feel where you need to give more energy, where you need to go slow or go fast, and where you can go in deeper.

Once you have a clear path and target in mind, you can take crossroads. In other words, once you get the basics right, you'll find places where you can improvise. A screenplay forces you to think about how you cut your message into digestible pieces and how you design for energy and interaction from the audience.

A message well sent is a message well received. Facilitate the receiver and work with a screenplay!

Rens de Jong
Moderator, Radio & TV Anchor,
Entrepreneur



TOOL SCREENPLAYS



FOCUS

define screenplay



± 45 MIN

work session



1-2

people

Just like it does in movie-making, a screenplay provides an efficient and effective way to design a meeting. The more thorough the screenplay, the better the meeting.

THIS IS YOUR FACILITATION DESIGN TOOL

Screenplays help you to design a meeting or workshop and share this with the key stakeholders and facilitators. Well-designed screenplays enable you to gain clarity about what can be done during a workshop in order to make decisions about time, activities, and topics to be covered. Most important, a screenplay is a visual tool to help you design for results while managing all of the information in one simple document.

DESIGN FOR FLEXIBILITY

One misunderstanding is that the screenplay is fixed and therefore not flexible. That's not true. The screenplay should be co-created with the core team to help everyone design a results-driven meeting or workshop. In this way, a screenplay will actually help you to be flexible.

I LOVE IT WHEN A PLAN COMES TOGETHER.

// Hannibal, A-Team

Moreover, when you design your screenplays in blocks of time/activities, it enables you to shift to new blocks should the expected-unexpected occur, like lateness due to traffic jams, etc.

BE EARLY

Make sure to arrive at least an hour before the start of the workshop to make sure everything works, that there is coffee and water available, and to test the wifi and the projector.

AGENDA, ROLES, RULES

Always start with agenda, roles, rules, and outcomes. Agree on these with the team.

TIME SLOTS

The minimum length to schedule is 15 minutes, but preferably work in 30-minute increments.

STRATEGIC VISION

You can design strategic vision. For more info look at the vision section in Point of View, page 58.

COFFEE BREAKS

Never skip coffee breaks. And yes, they really take 30 minutes. People need a break!

WRAP-UP

In the wrap-up, come back to the objectives and make sure everything is covered.

CALL SHEET

Who	Role
Marc McLaughlin	Host & Moderator
Maarten van Lieshout	Visualizer
Eefje Jonker	Strategy designer
Mr. Wolf	Facility manager
Josephine Green	Catering

SCREENPLAY Workshop

Location: Amsterdam
Time: 09:00 - 12:30

Time	Topic
09:00 15 min	Setup and introduction
09:15 90 min	Team Exercise Strategic Visioning What is our long-term vision and ambition level? What impact does this have on our business model? What are the implications of our ambition level for the business model?
10:45 30 min	Break
11:15 60 min	Share your vision story! Teams will present their visions to others and get feedback
12:15 15 min	Wrap-up

Workshop STRATEGIC Visioning for <Client> on <Date>

Responsibility	Contact Details
Inspire & guide throughout the day	<Phone> <Mail>
Visual facilitation	<Phone> <Mail>
Achieve best possible outcome	

STRATEGIC Visioning for <Client> on <Date>

Activity	Who?
Short background – Why are we here? Agenda (drawing) Roles and rules Outcome of workshop	Workshop host
Explain exercise What is vision? (5 minutes) Explain strategic visioning map, 5 Bold Steps Vision® (10 minutes)	On screen by Strategy designer Supported by facilitator
Team exercise Divide into groups of 4–6 people Put sticky notes on vision, vision themes, and how this shows up (60 minutes) Determine the 5 bold steps (15 min)	Strategy designer
Capture Collect flip charts and take pictures – mark captured flip charts.	Teams present Strategy designer connects
Plenary presentations Plenary presentations by teams (30 min) Identify top 3 makers & breakers (15 min) Determine design criteria (15 min)	Strategy designer
Wrap-up Wrap-up of learning this morning. Next steps. End the workshop.	

CALL SHEET

Make a call sheet with the most important people needed during the day. Take special care to become friends with the location's technical people – they can save your day.

LOCATION CHECK

Always check the location before you run a workshop there. Nasty surprises will ruin the outcome of your session.

LOCATION CHECKLIST

- ☐ LOTS OF WALL SPACE
- ☐ ABLE TO TAPE TEMPLATES TO THE WALL
- ☐ SPACE TO WALK AROUND
- ☐ DAYLIGHT AND FRESH AIR
- ☐ NO DISTRACTIONS
- ☐ REFRESHMENTS
- ☐ TABLES NOT AS CONFERENCE BUT TABLE GROUPS
- ☐ ABLE TO PLAY MUSIC DURING EXERCISES



DOWNLOAD

Download example screenplays and call sheets from www.designabetterbusiness.com

CHECKLIST

- ☐ Check the lengths of the time slots and breaks.
- ☐ Clear actions per time slot.
- ☐ Call sheet.

NEXT STEP

- > Run your workshop, meeting, or offsite.

TOOL TEAM CHARTER



PERSONAL

get to know your team



± 30 MIN

session



3–5

people per group

Now that you've put all of these unusual suspects and diverse characters together in one room, how will you agree on your goals, expectations, and values? And how will you deal with challenging situations? Design a team charter together!

SIGN THE CHARTER

You don't always get to decide with whom you work with. Even if you do, there's no guarantee that you'll be successful. Conflicts of interest and differing values or goals often get in the way of a team's progress.

A team charter will help you create a blueprint for the engine behind a project: a well-balanced team. As a co-created document, the team charter will help clarify the team's direction while establishing boundaries.

The team charter serves two purposes. Firstly, using the charter as an inward-facing document, team members can point out why the team was established in the first place, what the main focus is, and

what direction the team will take to achieve its stated goals. Secondly, as an outward-facing document, the charter can help to educate managers and other organizational leaders about the focus and direction of the team.

TEAM VALUES

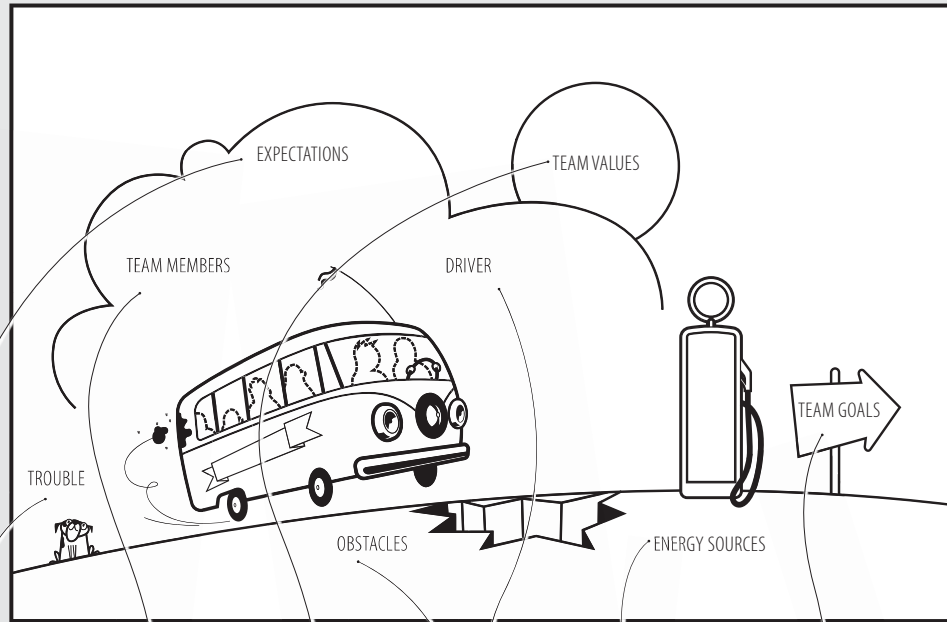
Together, you'll need to decide on the values your team upholds as part of its collaboration. These values will help form the foundation for a successful team, which will make it easier to reach the goal while reducing confusion about the team's objectives. What's more, the charter will provide clear guidelines about how team members will work together and what each person will contribute, which will help ensure the team moves forward and not backward.

Some of the things you'll want to include in your team charter are the following: team members; team goals, expectations, and the purpose for existing in the first place; team values; how the team handles trouble and obstacles; who the team leaders are. Don't be afraid to add things like "have fun!" and energy sources, like "team dinner once per week." These will go a long way in helping the team gel.

Whatever form your team charter takes, just make sure you're all on the same page. In the end you want to have a team of people who build off each other, not a group of people just doing a job.

**GOOD TO KNOW WHO
YOU'RE TRAVELING
WITH!**

TEAM CHARTER CANVAS



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 171 Second Street, Suite 305, San Francisco, California, 94105, USA.

TROUBLE

What will you do when the shit hits the "van"?

EXPECTATIONS

What do the team members expect from each other in order to be successful?

TEAM MEMBERS

Who is on the bus and what will each person individually bring to the team: e.g., role, personal core value, skills, personal slogan, character trait?

TEAM VALUES

What are the values the team lives by? Are these values recognized by all team members?

DRIVER

Who is behind the wheel? Who is navigating?

OBSTACLES

What could prevent the team from working together fruitfully and reaching their goal?

ENERGY SOURCES

What generates energy in the group? What gets everybody running and going for the best results?

TEAM GOAL

What is the goal the team wants to reach? When are all the team efforts successful?



DOWNLOAD

Download the team charter template from www.designabetterbusiness.com

CHECKLIST

- ☐ You defined the team goal.
- ☐ You defined the driver, team members, and values.
- ☐ You defined obstacles and energy sources.
- ☐ You had everyone sign the charter.

NEXT STEP

- > Go get started with Point of View!

YOU NOW HAVE . . .

- PREPARED **YOUR TEAM** P30
- PREPARED **YOUR ENVIRONMENT** P32
- BUILT **YOUR TEAM CHARTER** P42

NEXT STEPS

- **DEVELOP A POINT OF VIEW** P46
It will help you decide how to approach your design journey.
- **DESIGN A VISION** P58
Formulate an actionable vision with your team.
- **APPLY DESIGN CRITERIA** P68
What are the principles and the benchmarks of the change you're after?

RECAP

DON'T FLY SOLO. **THE LONE GENIUS IS DEAD.**

PREPARE. SET YOURSELF UP FOR **SUCCESS.**

BUILD A MULTI-DISCIPLINARY TEAM.

DIVERSITY IS KEY.

FIND AN EXECUTIVE SPONSOR. CREATE AMBASSADORS.

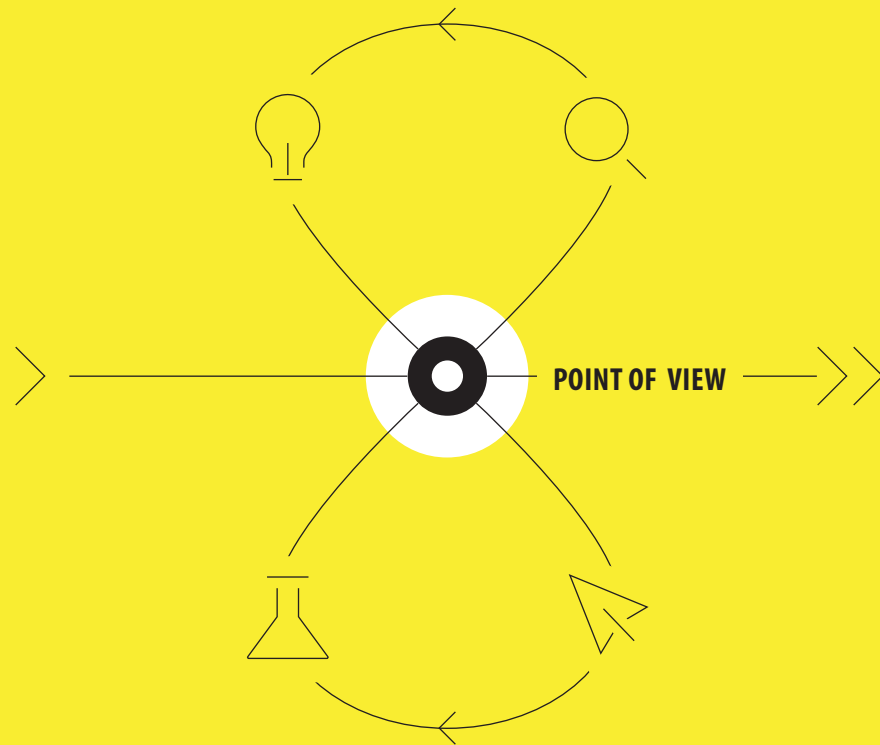
WORK VISUALLY. YOUR BRAIN WILL THANK YOU FOR IT.

MANAGE THE ENERGY.

**NOW,
LET'S GET
STARTED!**



POINT



THE DESIGN JOURNEY **POINT OF VIEW**

BE A **REBEL**

DEVELOP **YOUR VISION**

DESIGN **YOUR STORY**

CREATE **DESIGN CRITERIA**

INTRO	YOUR POINT OF VIEW	P48
SKILL	DARE TO STEP UP	P50
TOOL	YOUR VISION OF THE FUTURE	P56
TOOL	5 BOLD STEPS VISION® CANVAS	P58
CASE	SHARING THE VISION OF ING BANK	P60
TOOL	COVER STORY VISION® CANVAS	P64
TOOL	DESIGN CRITERIA	P68
TOOL	STORYTELLING CANVAS	P74
CASE	TELLING THE STORY OF AUDI	P76

YOUR **POINT OF VIEW**

Every design journey starts somewhere. Perhaps that somewhere is a brand-new company searching for its sustainable (money-making) business model. Or maybe the journey is being taken by an existing business looking for new directions so it can stay competitive and grow. In every case, the journey you take will start with a point of view.

Whether it's about a market, or a customer, or a product or service, or even a competitor, we all have a point of view. Being at the center of the design journey, your point of view is your most valuable asset. It provides the litmus test for what's real and what's just a mirage. As a designer you are responsible for actively shaping your point of view based on what you learn along the way.

THE FIRST STEP IS ALWAYS THE HARDEST

Developing new business ideas from scratch can seem like a daunting task. When you're a startup, you have hope in your heart that your company will become the next big thing. You work hard at developing and selling your product – but often, the harder you work, the further away your dreams seem to be. When you're an established business, you've been driving the same executional strategy for many, many years. Your shareholders enjoy the fruits of your labor in the form of increasing share prices and dividends, and your board looks to past growth for future strategy. However, these past successes may become a burden as you try to steer your company into new waters.

To create change, you must start with your point of view, even when the odds seemed stacked against you. Maybe you're thinking, "But it's just my point of view! What changes could I possibly make based on what I think?!" You wouldn't be wrong – or the first person – to think this. However, when you pair your point of view with specific tools, skills, and a mindset to match, you absolutely can create the change you're looking for.

BE A REBEL

If you're looking to influence someone, especially someone you need on your team to turn your point of view into a successful strategy, it may sound counterintuitive to say that you should be a rebel. But it's precisely the rebel, and the points of view that she brings with her, that will serve as the catalyst for change. Being a rebel does not mean you must go against everything that your company or leadership stand for. Rather, being a rebel is about coming to the table with a strong point of view toward the future. You do not need to buck the establishment – but you do need to question the establishment and bring to the table those big ideas that you feel in your gut are worth exploring.



For how to use
a strong point of
view to design a
better business,
read:
Zero to One by
Peter Thiel

LET YOUR VISION BE YOUR ROADMAP

A strong point of view will serve as your catalyst for change. It is your vision for the future that will serve as the roadmap leading to the change you seek to make. People argue their points of view over beers. Visions set direction (maybe so that you can buy even more beer with the money you'll make in the future!).

Our definition of “vision” is different than what you'll find in other books or articles. It's not just a statement: it's a rallying cry. The concept of vision is all-encompassing; it includes the supporting factors that make the vision real, the steps you need to take to realize the vision, and the challenges and opportunities that you'll face on your way to achieving your vision. To make your vision tangible and useful, this chapter lays out co-creative tools that you can – and should – use with your team.

DESIGN YOUR STORY

When you enter that boardroom, or strategy meeting, or VC pitch, what are you going to say? How will you sway people to your point of view, or at least convince them to explore your vision with you? This is where stories make a big difference. Ever notice how the best speakers, whether giving a TED talk,

presenting in a conference room, or holding court in a bar, use anecdotes and stories to convey the points they are making? Though naturally talented speakers may do this somewhat instinctively, anyone who does this well is deliberate about what stories they tell, how, when, and to whom: to make your mark and gain the buy-in you need, you'll need to explore your point of view. In other words, you'll need to design your story.

But don't let that worry you. Just as we are giving you new tools to create your vision, we are also sharing great tools to help you design your story.

DESIGN CRITERIA

Your vision points to a future state. Yet it's not just any future state. The changes you seek to make along your design journey likely must also meet a set of criteria about what you must, could, should, or absolutely won't do as you explore and evaluate options for the future. These are design criteria. They provide both a foundation and clear boundaries to help guide your decisions along the way. Your design criteria will be informed by the vision you create as well as the context surrounding your organization. Similarly, the options you explore will be informed by the same design criteria. ■

5 Bold Steps
Vision® Canvas
(this chapter)
page 58

Design Criteria
Canvas (this
chapter)
page 68

Cover Story
Vision® Canvas
(this chapter)
page 64

Storytelling Can-
vas (this chapter)
page 74

DARE TO **STEP UP**

Everybody has a point of view. Very few dare to step up. They believe they are not the right person to do that as it is not in their job description. It was not in mine either: I am the CFO. Yet I decided to step out of my comfort zone – the only way to make a difference.

WE WERE HUNGRY FOR VISION

Our organization had gone through some pretty rough times in the recent past. You could feel that in the energy of the organization. The financial crisis had taken a toll, and a merger between two companies (BNP Paribas and Fortis Bank) had created a cultural disconnect – and I realized that our discussions were too focused on what had happened in the past. People were questioning our company identity. I, of course, agreed with my co-workers, but even those conversations were very difficult and even disruptive.

TIP 1

**STICK TO YOUR BELIEFS.
IF YOU DON'T, HOW CAN YOU
EVER TRUST OTHERS TO DO SO?**

As a large ship sailing forward, we often don't think we have much time for self-reflection. But I felt we needed to take a step back, describe our situation, and then get over it and get going. This didn't

mean sweeping our problems under the rug – we needed to talk about them and learn from them. And then we needed to move forward.

RESHUFFLE THE FOCUS TO THE FUTURE

With all of our fears, uncertainties, and doubts, I felt that it was time to reshuffle the focus and start looking forward. Although as the CFO it was not necessarily my role, I decided to step up and make it happen. In fact, I think that anyone and everyone in our organization should be able to step up and take new and broader sets of responsibilities than what they were hired for. But, as the CFO, I was a bit perplexed: how could I focus on the future and not just the forecasted future the numbers usually tell? What would the future look like? With changes happening rapidly in our world (the banking world), I knew one thing for sure: numbers would not tell the story we needed. Nor would numbers get people to believe in our future.

TIP 2

DARE TO BE YOURSELF: SHOW UP AT YOUR JOB THE SAME AS YOU WOULD SHOW UP IN YOUR PRIVATE LIFE.

To me, it became clear that our future is not as much about numbers as it is about our story. And to rebuild our story, I needed not just number-driven IQ, but also emotionally-driven EQ. I needed to get people to let go of their negative emotions and build our future based on positive ones. We needed to build on where we came from, what we had become, who we are, and what's in our DNA.

STEP FORWARD

I was the one who stepped forward. This was quite extraordinary when you consider that my role was the CFO – a numbers guy. This, in fact, was the first time in my career that I felt the need to do this. Sure, I'd held leadership positions for a long time. But this bank is in my DNA and I wanted to design a future that would last.



I AM MASTER OF MY FATE

I never imagined myself being the host of our management offsite. But here I was, dressed in black, standing on a 360-degree stage and introducing my colleagues who presented their vision stories to an inspired audience. This was a vision designed and told by us. Not some boring strategic plan put together by consultants. We designed this experience in order to get 250 other colleagues to want to contribute as well. Our bank had never done this before. We empowered people to take one step toward the future. Music and scenes from the movie *Invictus* supported our vision, empowering people to be the masters of our fate and future.

It was an exciting journey and many people joined, exploring the unexplored. It was not easy. But the plan came together. I practiced what I preached. I am the master of my fate and future.



Emmanuel Buttin
Business Line CFO,
BNP Paribas

GO BEYOND YOURSELF EVERYDAY. ONLY THEN DO WE COMMIT OURSELVES TO GROWTH.

Inasmuch as I feel that people need to step out of their comfort zones and help steer the ship, I also believe you must feel somewhat comfortable stepping up and steering. That's not to say you won't be anxious the first time you step up. I know I was. But I believe being anxious enables you to be more open to new environments. You become sensitive to outside stimuli. And this is where you will find your vision. I did.

NO CLUE HOW TO DO IT

Being operationally minded, I did not know how to shift our focus to the near-term future. In fact, nobody on our team did. But I felt that if I made the first step forward, we would figure out how to make the next step together. At this moment, I realized that I was actually creating a movement. As people joined, they created the energy we needed to take more steps. Even more people were drawn to this energy and joined us. We had no clear path ahead of us as we took those first few steps, but it felt good to create our own optimistic path.

I also knew that most people in large organizations like ours would have a hard time joining movements like the one we started. It's

not that they don't want to. It's just that most of the time, executing today's strategy using current information is the more comfortable path. That's what we all learn to do in school, after all. But using yesterday's information to execute yesterday's strategy is a terrible excuse for not moving forward. All of the information in the world will not guarantee success if it's based on yesterday. Sure, you can hire third parties to design your vision and strategy for you. But then you're not taking responsibility for making it a success.

DO IT TOGETHER

As I stepped forward, other people stepped up to help design our future together. As we all took those first steps together, I recognized that the most interesting ideas came from having people from different departments, with varying ideas, share with each other. We wanted to create something different from what we'd done in the past. We didn't want to simply write our ideas down on a piece of paper, only for them to be forgotten in a few days. We believed that in order to live the vision, we needed to co-create it together and not wait for the Executive Committee. We wanted people from all levels of the organization to explore the story and tell the story.

CREATING A VISION WITH 250 PEOPLE

With various people from the organization, all of whom had other daily responsibilities, we began to forge our path forward. We collected information, talked to customers, and synchronized our stories on a map. It felt to me that we had the beginnings of a strong vision.

We hosted a two-day “Management University” event later that year: an opportune time to share our collective stories with one another. This was not a small event. Management University brought together 250 people from all over the organization and all over the world to have conversations about the future of the bank. I thought it was the perfect time to share and validate the vision I and my (now) 35-person core team had been working on for the past year. We all stepped up to the raised bar.

Each person, as part of our movement, had to tell a part of our story to the other 250 people in the audience. And, to make it more inclusive, we decided not to use a regular stage. Instead, we opted for a 360-degree stage with the presenters standing right in the middle – at the heart of the conversation. To raise the stakes even more, we decided not to use slides at all. We would give TED-style keynotes that were meant to inspire our teams.

EXERCISE: WHO ARE WE AS A BANK?

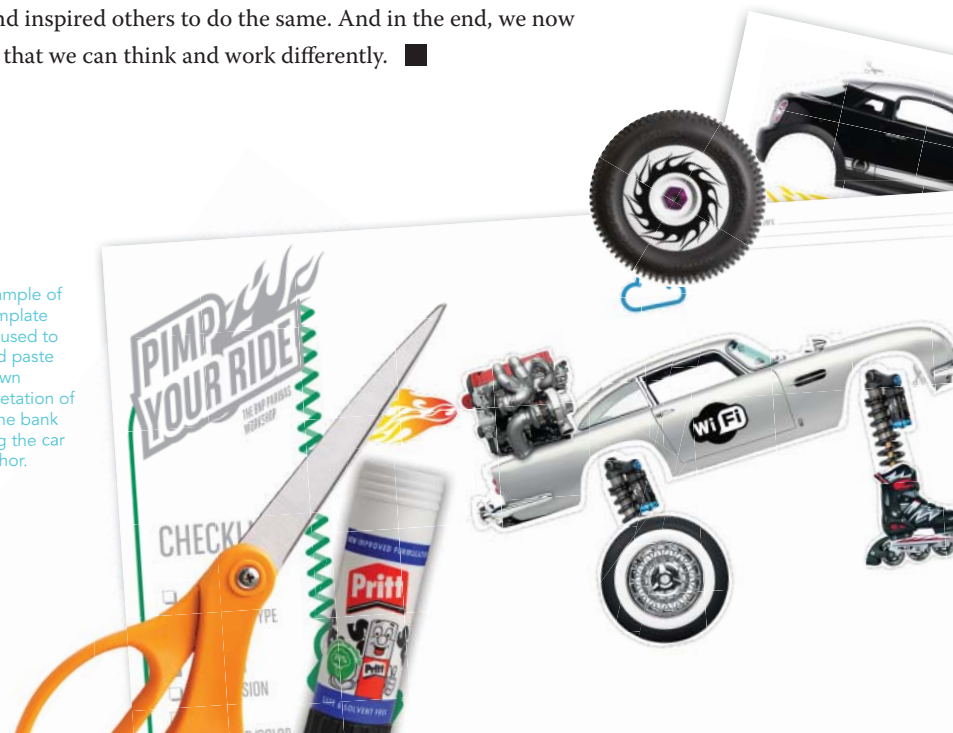
Our vision story went over really well. But to get everyone involved – and not just the 35 people who co-created the foundations of the vision – we kicked off the day with a communal exercise focused on “who we are as a bank.” Harkening back to our more creative days, we used scissors, pictures of car parts, markers, and tape to design the bank we felt we were in the present. Given how unusual this exercise must have sounded (and maybe even sounds to you now), we were surprised at

how readily people picked up their tools and designed a car together – it only took about 20 minutes. We had fun and shared stories about our company’s DNA. Everyone felt proud that we had taken this step.

LASTING IMPACT FOR THE BANK

I can say without a doubt that the bank and the bank's leadership have learned a great deal. I feel that we made the first big step in embracing a new way of working together. This new way of working is about trusting others to help steer the ship. It's not about hiring consultants to draw you the map. We did it ourselves. We spotted new talent in our organization who stepped up and inspired others to do the same. And in the end, we now trust that we can think and work differently. ■

An example of the template teams used to cut and paste their own interpretation of what the bank is using the car metaphor.



STORIES OF **POINT OF VIEW**

TANGIBLE STRATEGY

There was a Homer Simpson “duh” moment where we collectively realized one of the things we often did was completely over-engineer and over-design the next steps – so the 5 bold steps was a really easy way to record tangible next steps that were both audacious and compelling. Instead of an abstract strategy, we all were eager to take them!

// Vicky Seeley – COO – Sheppard Moscow LLC

Stay true to your vision – don’t change to fit the agenda of others.

// Sue Black, University of Dundee

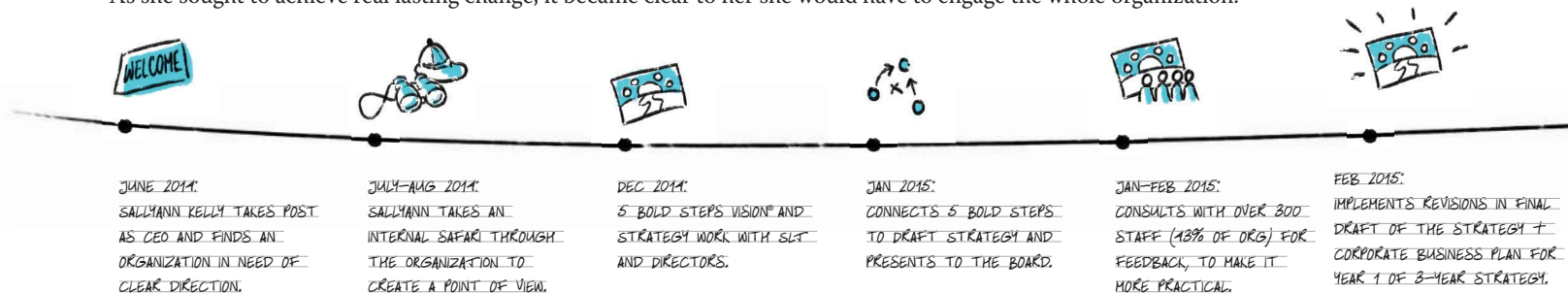
Siemens Healthcare, Turkey

As the Sales and Marketing Board of Siemens Healthcare, Turkey, we discussed our vision and business strategy during the aftermath of a recent restructuring and repositioning. All our discussions about our business model and context strongly related to our vision. The 5 Bold Steps Vision® Canvas became the source of most actions we agreed upon.

// Enis Sonemel – Siemens Healthcare, Turkey – Country Lead, Diagnostic Imaging

A Connected Vision

SallyAnn Kelly joined as CEO of Aberlour Childcare Trust with a clear mandate: to embed a clear strategy. As she sought to achieve real lasting change, it became clear to her she would have to engage the whole organization.



Mindpearl

At Mindpearl we needed to reshape the way we promote ourselves and talk about ourselves. Our language had become too complicated and distant. We defined a clear vision based on where we came from, who we are, and who we want to be. Our people are now able to reconnect with our global identity. We realigned our actions and narrative.

// Karin Dale, General Manager, Mindpearl

Now I can share my strategy on one page!

// Craig Mohan, Managing Director, Market Technology and Data Services, CME Group Chicago

BULLETPROOF VISION

While working on the cover story, one team from a producer of aramid fiber, the ballistics unit, came up with "Obama buys a bulletproof Dolce & Gabbana dress for his wife for Xmas." The entire team was laughing. Nobody really understood what it could mean at first. But then, as we came back down to earth, we realized it was about having fashionable bulletproof clothing. Not those ugly jackets and vests. There is absolutely a need for this, especially among rich and famous in certain countries.

A VISION PER DIVISION

Our departments of Orthopedics, Dermatology, Oncology, and Mother and Child took up the responsibility to map out a vision separately. We soon learned that it is more interesting/productive/better to use a co-creative design process. Vision is about alignment. It was crucial for us to create a vision with the customer in mind.

This was a huge step for our hospital; we previously had a perspective that prioritized expertise and excellent treatments, rather than a customer-centric perspective. After designing our new vision, we wanted to communicate both inside and outside the hospital. We used visuals and a move to create a clear story.

// Frits van Merode, Member, Executive Board Maastricht University Medical Center



WOULDN'T IT BE GREAT TO
CREATE A MINI STRATEGY
BOOKLET FOR EMPLOYEES?



MARCH 2015:
PRESENTS STRATEGY TO
THE BOARD.



APRIL-JULY 2015:
WORKSHOP TO ENGAGE
STAFF/EMPLOYEES WITH THE
STRATEGY (WHAT DOES IT
MEAN FOR YOU? WHAT ACTIONS
WILL YOU TAKE?).



APRIL 2015:
CREATES MINI VISUAL STRATEGY
BOOKLETS AND SENDS A
PERSONAL COPY + THANK YOU
LETTER IN THE POST TO EACH
EMPLOYEE.



MAY-DEC 2015:
IMPLEMENTS YEAR 1 OF
STRATEGY. NEW INITIATIVES
LAUNCHED IN SUPPORT OF
VISION ELEMENTS.



JAN 2016:
STRATEGY REVIEW DAY. BUILD/
MEASURE/LEARN LOOP PUT IN
PLACE.

YOUR VISION OF THE FUTURE

The first thing most people do when they hear the word “vision” in a business context is yawn. That’s because most visions are vague, unclear, and, frankly, nothing to get excited about. Well-designed visions should be rallying cries for action, invention, and innovation.

VISION AS YOUR COMPASS

When you’ve formulated your point of view with an eye toward the future, it’s the vision that will guide you and your team toward the North Star. A clear vision brings focus and provides an anchor point for making bold strategic choices. It drives the search for new business models. As a rallying cry, a clear and compelling vision provides direction in everything you and your colleagues do. Ask each other this question every day: Does this action, activity, experiment, project get us closer to realizing our vision? If the answer is no, then don’t waste time, energy, and money on it. A vision is a compass that ensures your people and teams work on those things that matter to customers, clients, and other stakeholders. It will inspire, engage, and activate people so they are able to do a better job.

A VISION IS NOT A VISION STATEMENT

A vision statement is the headline to a much richer story about your future. It is an anchor for the bigger story. While a vision statement is an aspirational description of what your team (or organization) would like to achieve or accomplish in the mid- or long-term future, to be truly useful (and powerful), a vision statement must point out not only where you want to go and when, but also how you’re going to get there.

A VISION BEYOND VISION STATEMENTS!

The first step in vision design is about going beyond the vision statement. Yes, the vision should address the vision statement, the underlying themes and the examples where vision shows up. However, if the vision is meant to be a rallying cry for the future, then it must be designed – or at least embodied – by the entire organization. The process of designing the vision must take into account the values your organization lives by as well your realistic mid- and long-term goals. The vision you create with your company (or team) must outline the key objectives as well as high-level tactics and the elements of your business and values that support them. This will enable the various teams in your company to develop strategies to achieve the goals stated in the vision. With a single unifying vision, employees will all be on the same page and marching to the same drummer. Your vision will become the North Star for the future.

THREE BUILDING BLOCKS OF A PRACTICAL VISION

A high-quality, practical, and inspiring vision for any organization should have three key characteristics: it needs to state where the company wants to be in the near future (2–5 years); it must contain a level of inspiration and excitement (the rallying cry); and it must detail the bold steps by which to achieve the vision.

DON'T LOSE **SLEEP** OVER IT

Aart Roos, CEO of Auping, a Dutch-based bed design and production company, decided to approach his company's vision design in a very different way. Instead of formulating the vision in the Executive Suite, isolated from his customers, Aart turned to his customers to co-create Auping's vision with them and for them.

Customers stated, "Sleep is the most important thing for me to feel healthy and energetic, to be able to really live!"

Today, Auping's communication focuses less on the production of their beds and more on what their customers find important about their beds: an energetic day. Their tagline: "Auping nights, better days."

Aart J. Roos
CEO, Auping



WHERE SHALL WE START?

To craft a vision that becomes your rallying cry, bring together a team and empower them to design the future. This is about pairing energy, fun, creativity, and ambition. To get started, dream big. Don't worry about your daily job. Brainstorm with your team to visualize where you may see yourselves in the mid- and long-term future.

Ask yourself what problems your team (or organization) hopes to solve in the next few years. What do you hope to achieve? Who is your target customer base, and what do you want to do for them? What will your future business model look like?

WHAT SUPPORTS OUR VISION?

As you and your team begin to create the ideas of your future together, you'll also need to capture the aspects of your organization, your strategy, and the broader context that will help support your vision. The key to capturing the support for your vision is to ask yourself (and your team): "Why us? Why now?" What does your organization value or do that will support your vision? What parts of your organization's broader context – perhaps even trends – will further bolster your vision? ■

TOOL 5 BOLD STEPS VISION®

Original created by David Sibbet, The Grove Consultants International



PERSONAL

build your vision



± 90 MIN

pressure cooker



3–5

people per group

If you want to make positive, future-oriented change in your organization, you'll need to go beyond writing long-winded paper visions and come to a shared agreement about what you are going to fight for together and what steps you are going to take to get "there." The 5 Bold Steps Vision® Canvas is a perfect tool to align your teams in your organization.

THE STEPS TO TAKE

The vision canvas will help you co-design the vision as well as the 5 bold steps to achieve that vision. Additionally, using this tool, your team will be able to clarify what supports your vision, what challenges your vision, and what opportunities are created in working toward your vision. Best of all, the vision canvas will help you derive design criteria for your business model(s) and strategy.

COLLECTIVE STATEMENT

A vision statement is sometimes called a picture of your company in the future. But it's so much more than that. Your vision statement is your inspiration, the framework for all your strategic planning. When creating your initial vision statement you are essentially articulating your dreams for your business. This should stand as a reminder of what you're trying to accomplish together.

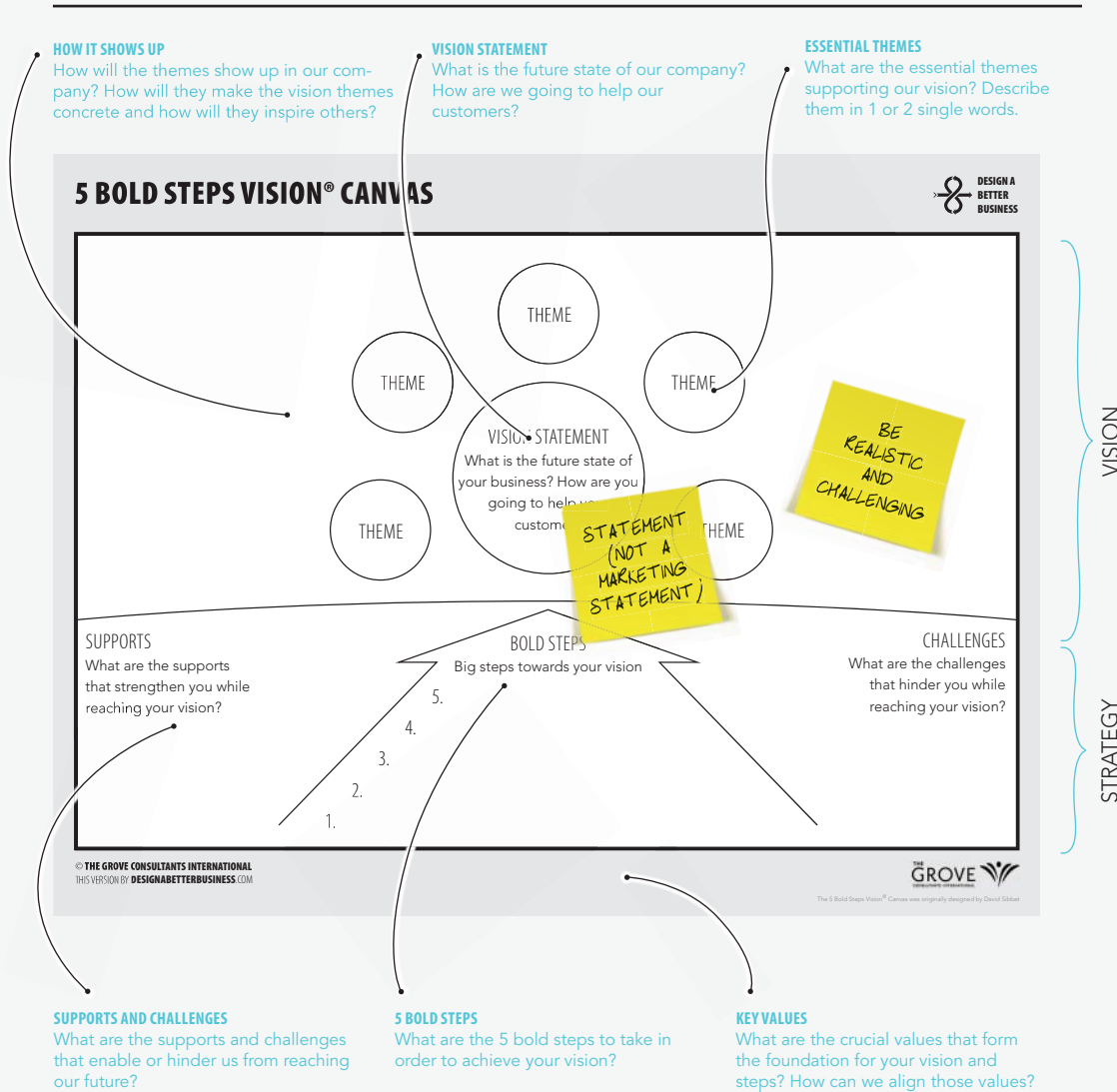
It may apply to your entire company or to a single division of the company. Whether for all or part of an organization, the vision statement answers the question "Where do we want to go?"

CONCRETE GUIDELINES

Probably the greatest aspect of the vision canvas is that your entire vision, including actions, supports, opportunities, and challenges, will be on one sheet of paper – not a book! It's simple to share and easy to translate into concrete guidelines that decision makers (and executors) need to get their jobs done. Even better, creating a visualization of the vision, based on this canvas, will help you spread the word.

READY, SET . . . GO!

Regardless of the approach you choose to compose your vision, you'll need to involve the right people. This includes the decision makers as well as everybody else! A vision without actions or ambassadors to carry the message forward is worth no more than the paper it's printed on, no matter how well crafted. ■



DOWNLOAD
Download the 5 Bold Steps Vision® Canvas from www.designabetterbusiness.com

59

CHECKLIST

- ☐ You identified five steps to achieve your vision.
- ☐ Your vision statement is supported by clear themes and the realistic ways it shows up.
- ☐ You filtered out criteria to design your business model(s) and value proposition.

NEXT STEPS

- > Check how this vision resonates with others.

CASE 5 BOLD STEPS VISION® ING BANK

5 BOLD STEPS VISION® CANVAS

CONFIDENTIAL
STRATEGY
DOCUMENT

PROTECTION

IN THE BANKING INDUSTRY

FOR FINANCIAL ADVICE



TO REDEFINE THEIR VISION, ING HAD WRITTEN A CORPORATE STRATEGY DOCUMENT. VALUABLE INFORMATION, BUT HOW DO WE TRANSLATE IT INTO AN ACTIONABLE VISION?

THE TEAMS DECIDED TO CUT OUT THE HEADERS OF THE IMPORTANT PAGES AND USED THEM TO INITIALLY PLOT THE VISION THEMES AND HOW THEY SHOW UP.

SUPPORTS

SIMPLE
PROCESSES

PLAIN
LANGUAGE

FAIR
PRICES

BANK IN YOUR
POCKET

CLIENT'S
ONLINE
24/7

ANY TIME
ANYWHERE

CLEAR AND
EASY

CLEAR
PRODUCTS

ANTICIPATE

EMPOWER

EMPOWERING
PEOPLE TO
STAY AHEAD
IN LIFE AND
BUSINESS

BOLD STEPS

EARN PRIMARY
RELATIONSHIP



DESIGN A
BETTER
BUSINESS

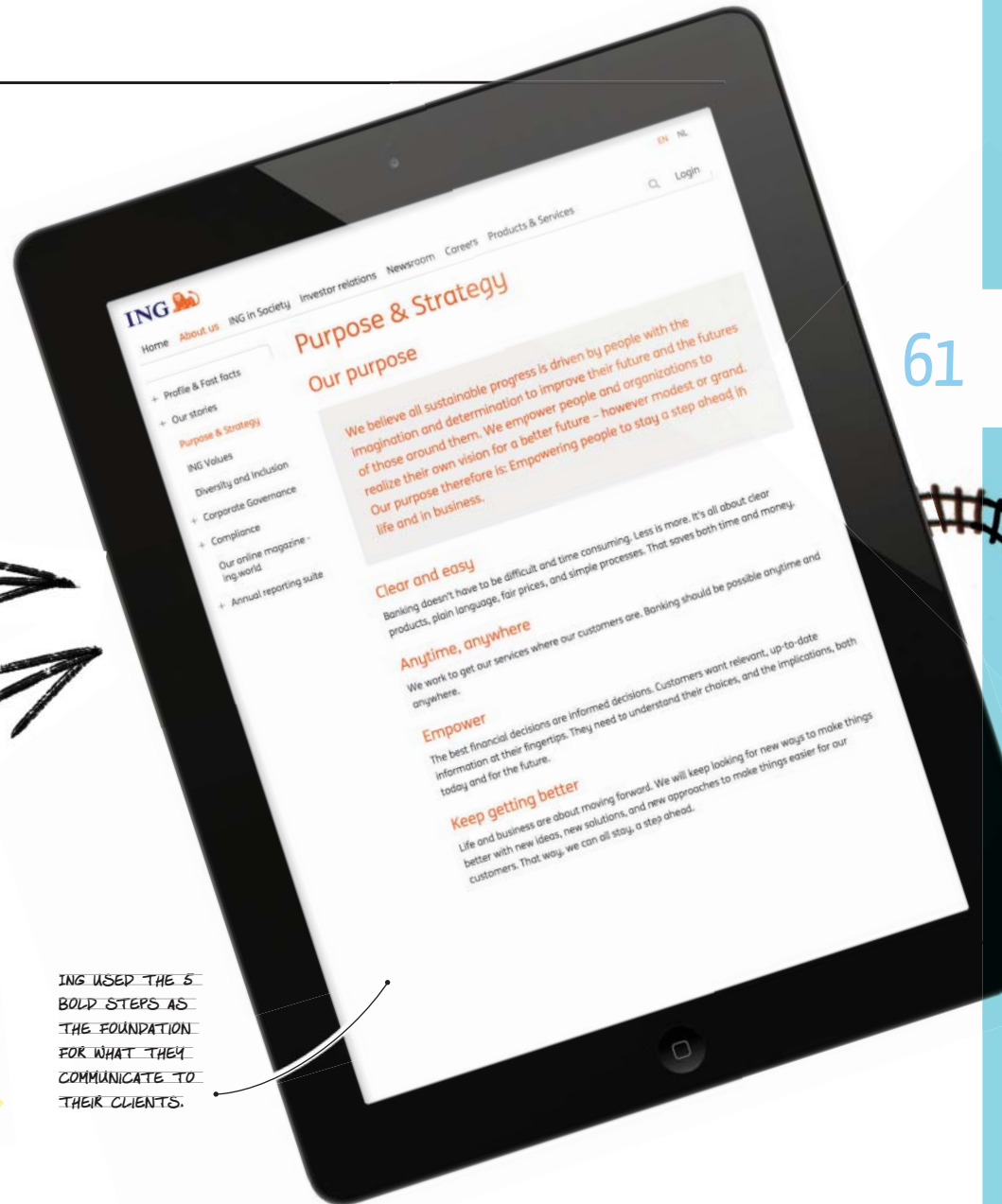
POINT OF VIEW » TOOL » CASE » 5 BOLD STEPS



CHALLENGES

THE
GROVE
CONSULTANTS INTERNATIONAL

The 5 Bold Steps Vision® Canvas was originally designed by David Sibbett



ING USED THE 5
BOLD STEPS AS
THE FOUNDATION
FOR WHAT THEY
COMMUNICATE TO
THEIR CLIENTS.

ALONG WITH THE FIRST DRAFT OF THE VISION,
VISUAL NOTES WERE TAKEN DURING THE MEETING.
THEY NOW HAVE A PROMINENT SPOT IN THE OFFICE
SO EVERYONE CAN GET INSPIRED.



A VISION ON ONE PAGE

When our new CEO, Ralph Hamers, came on board the company was ready for a bold new strategy. Banks had emerged from the financial crisis to find themselves facing a whole new raft of fintech competitors. At the same time, seamless digital experiences from companies like Amazon and Spotify had raised the customer-expectation bar for banks as well.

After a thorough strategic review, we had a plan of 250 pages. But how could we condense that down to something that would inspire employees throughout the bank? Could we make sure everyone communicated consistently about the strategy?

We put together a team from across Strategy, Internal and External Communications, Investor Relations, and Human Resources. Using the 5 Bold Steps Vision®, we were able to co-create our “strategy on a page,” linking the purpose and vision to clear strategic priorities. It provided clear direction and ensured that everyone across the bank would interpret and explain the strategy consistently. That strategy on a page still guides us today.

Dorothy Hill
VP of Strategy,
ING Bank



TOOL COVER STORY VISION

Original created by David Sibbet, The Grove Consultants International



PERSONAL

explore your vision



± 45 MIN

pressure cooker



3–5

people per group



For more
information on
the cover story,
read:
Visual Meetings
by David Sibbet

What is the most amazing future you see for your company (and yourself)? Who has the boldest vision ever? Imagine how you will appear on magazine covers. What's the word on the street? Creating a cover story will help you get into a future state of mind.

WHAT THEY'LL WRITE ABOUT YOU

The Cover Story Vision® Canvas challenges you and your team to project yourselves in the future: how will the world respond to what you have accomplished at that time. Mind you, this tool will (probably) not provide you with a turnkey vision. But it will challenge you to think beyond the realm of the known and safe. Why else would there be a story about your company in one of the world's bestselling magazines? This canvas will provide you with plenty of material you can use when formulating your actual vision. Furthermore, because it's tactile and visual, the vision canvas will elicit tons of feedback.

MAGAZINE (OR EZINE)

To get started, huddle as a team (or, even better, multiple teams) and have a thoughtful discussion about what magazine you'd like to be featured in once you've achieved your vision. It's important to have this conversation, as the tone, voice, and readership of the particular magazine make a big difference. Whatever you decide on, you'll find this conversation fun and stimulating.

HEADLINES

Once you've decided on your magazine, move on to the headline. What are the biggest, most inspirational headlines you can think of? How are you changing the world (or at least your organization) with your idea? This article will talk about your major achievement, but will also recount the story of where you started and how you got to your a-ha moment. What's the bottom line, the facts and figures that support the headline? Capture those as well.

As in any magazine article, there's going to be some kind of interview component. What questions will be asked? How will you answer? How will your skeptics show up? What are people saying on social media?

Now comes the fun part! Draw your story. Magazines are very visual. Make your magazine cover story visual as well. Who or what's on the cover? How will this grab the reader (i.e., your team)? ■

COVER

Make the cover really jump out. Don't limit yourself to just sticky notes. Draw or cut and paste pictures from magazines.

HEADLINES

Put down some eye-popping headlines. What would make people stop in their tracks and read the article?

BOTTOM LINE

What does it all boil down to? What has been achieved according to the article?

COVER STORY VISION® CANVAS

The diagram illustrates the Cover Story Vision Canvas, a tool for creating a compelling cover story. It is divided into several sections:

- MAGAZINE COVER:** A large rectangular area on the left for a visual representation of the cover.
- BIG HEADLINES:** A section for eye-catching headlines, illustrated with an orange sticky note that says "BIGGEST CHANGE EVER".
- THE INTERVIEW:** A section for the interview content, with a line pointing to a speech bubble containing a quote.
- THE BOTTOM LINE:** A section for the concluding statement or achievement.
- QUOTES:** A section for key quotes, illustrated with a yellow sticky note that says "CATCHY QUOTE" and a speech bubble.
- SOCIAL MEDIA:** Includes "TWEETS" (with a Twitter icon and a speech bubble containing "IS THIS FOR REAL?") and "INSTAGRAM PICTURES" (with an Instagram icon).
- #HASHTAGS:** A section for relevant hashtags, illustrated with a cloud shape.

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THIS VERSION BY DESIGNABETTERBUSINESS.COM

THE GROVE
CONSULTANTS INTERNATIONAL

The Cover Story Vision® Canvas was originally designed by David Sibbet

SOCIAL MEDIA

Use social media and Instagram photos to add more flavor to your story. What would get retweeted?

QUOTES

Don't just mention the positive quotes. Ask yourself how your competition and critics will respond.

INTERVIEW

Who is telling your story in the interview? Is it someone you work with? Your customer? What is the interview about?

**DOWNLOAD**

Download the Cover Story Vision® Canvas from www.designabetterbusiness.com

CHECKLIST

- ☐ You shared your cover story with your colleagues.
- ☐ You made your vision concrete with an engaging and visual cover.
- ☐ You stepped out of your (and your company's) comfort zone.
- ☐ You created a vision that can be realized in 5 years.

NEXT STEPS

- > Make your cover story concrete by using 5 Bold Steps Vision® Canvas.
- > Check how this vision resonates with others.

VISION HACKS



ASK THE CUSTOMER

Look at your vision from a fresh perspective with new insights. One way to do that is to ask some of your customers to help you with the 5 Bold Steps Vision® Canvas. What do they expect you to do? What is important to them? You'll be amazed how honored customers are when you invite them to think about your future!



VISION MOODBOARD

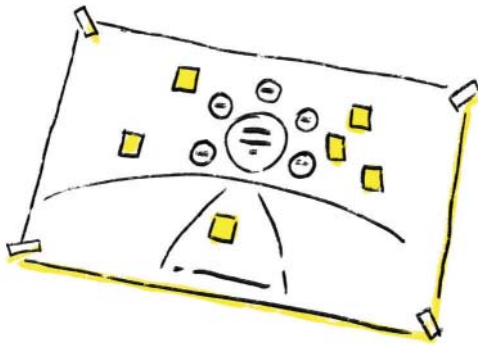
Collect a bunch of magazines and pass out scissors and glue to everyone on your team. What would happen if you would make a mood board about your vision? You can use the structure of the 5 Bold Steps Vision® Canvas (vision statement in the middle, themes surrounding, 5 steps + values underneath). This provides excellent conversation material and a beautiful "painting" of the first steps toward your future vision.



VISION MAGAZINE (COVER STORY)

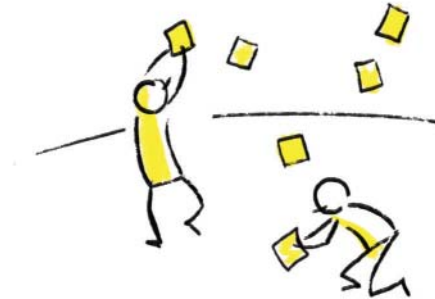
Have your team work on a vision magazine. Collect what people think. What is their vision? What themes surface?

Design a cover that reflects your future: the big impact you will have on the world. Publish and distribute the magazine throughout your company. The best fire starter ever. (See also "Cover Story Vision®" on page 64.)



START WITH STATEMENTS AND THEMES

Another way of working with the 5 Bold Steps Vision® Canvas is starting with the vision statement already filled out, including the supporting themes. The focus of the teams can be shifted to an in-depth exploration of the themes. Each team also needs to define the 5 bold steps for themselves. See the ING example on page 60 to read more about their experience with this approach.



START FROM SCRATCH

One way of going at it is to give your teams a blank canvas and see what they come up with. Get together and discuss and sync the canvases. This is a great way to get additional insights and design a better vision.



SHARE YOUR VISION (VISUALLY)

The 5 Bold Steps Vision® Canvas is a great blueprint for a concise story on stage or as a visual representation (see the ING case on page 60).

The best way to build up your story: start with the vision statement; show how it is substantiated by the vision themes (rank them). Explain how each theme will show up. Finish by explaining what steps you need to take to get there.

TOOL DESIGN CRITERIA



FOCUS

define design criteria



± 45 MIN

session



3–5

people per group

Whether you're designing a new value proposition, business model, or even an entire strategy for the future, design criteria form the principles and benchmarks of the change you're after. Design criteria are not formulated from thin air. Rather, design criteria incorporate information from your business, vision, customer research, cultural and economic context, and mindset that you have formed along the way.

WHAT ARE DESIGN CRITERIA?

Don't think of these criteria as simply features of your idea. They can and should be more than that. For example, a design criteria coming from your vision might be that your business must contribute to a greener planet. Or, maybe you want your customers to feel delighted; this is another design criterion. Does your new business idea need to generate a certain amount of revenue within three years? Chalk that up to more design criteria. In short, design criteria are there to make it easy to determine if you are on the right track.

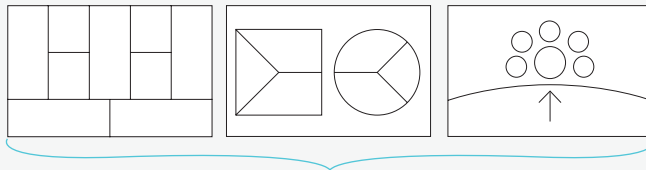
CREATING THE DESIGN CRITERIA

The design criteria you capture will likely first come from the vision you've formulated with your team. You'll find that some of the elements in that vision are so important that they are nonnegotiable. Yes, that also means that some elements are a bit more flexible (maybe not totally flexible). To find the most important elements in your vision, use the "MoSCoW" method: categorize every element under "Must," "Should," "Could," or "Won't." This will help you prioritize.

Now comes the easy part (well, maybe not easy, but doable): sort all of the nonnegotiable elements into the "Must" section of your design criteria and the rest into "Should" (if they are important) or the "Could" sections (if they would be nice to have).

Your vision makes up only part of the story when it comes to defining your design criteria. Other elements could include revenue, or your place in the market, or the impact you'll have, or the public perception of your company. Once you've come up with this list, add these to the "Could," "Should," or "Must" sections based on their respective priorities.

Once you've started this exercise, you might find that you need to adjust your vision slightly. This may prompt you to take a different direction. If that's the case, adjust the design criteria so that they match the new direction. As you continue to evolve your point of view, you may need to add or update your design criteria. ■



Use insights from the Business Model Canvas, VP Canvas, and Vision Canvas as input for the design criteria.

DESIGN CRITERIA CANVAS



MUST	
SHOULD	
COULD	
WON'T	

BY DESIGNABETTERBUSINESS.COM

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The MUST-HAVE prioritization method was originally developed by Dale Chang

MUST HAVES
Nonnegotiable elements that you can't leave out

SHOULD HAVES
Nonvital criteria you would love to have

COULD HAVES
Anything not immediately connected to realizing your vision

WON'T HAVES
Nonnegotiable things you definitely will NOT do



DOWNLOAD
Download the Design Criteria Canvas from www.designabetterbusiness.com

CHECKLIST

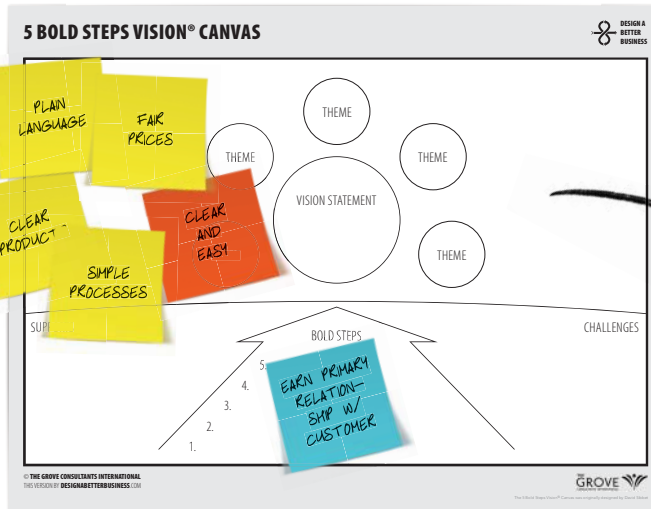
- ☐ You have sanitized the design criteria by removing unimportant criteria. Use, e.g., voting.
- ☐ You have spent time with your team to sharpen and quantify your criteria.
- ☐ You've linked up your design criteria with your vision.

NEXT STEPS

- > Quantify your design criteria: make them S.M.A.R.T. (specific, measurable, achievable, relevant, time-bound).
- > Revisit your design criteria. Do they still make sense?

EXAMPLE DESIGN CRITERIA ING BANK

5 Bold Steps Vision® Canvas
see
PAGE 58



HERE IS AN EXAMPLE OF HOW
ING SELECTED THE MOST
IMPORTANT DESIGN CRITERIA FOR
THEIR NEW BUSINESS MODEL AND
VALUE PROPOSITION.

FILTER OUT THE
DESIGN CRITERIA FROM
YOUR VISION.

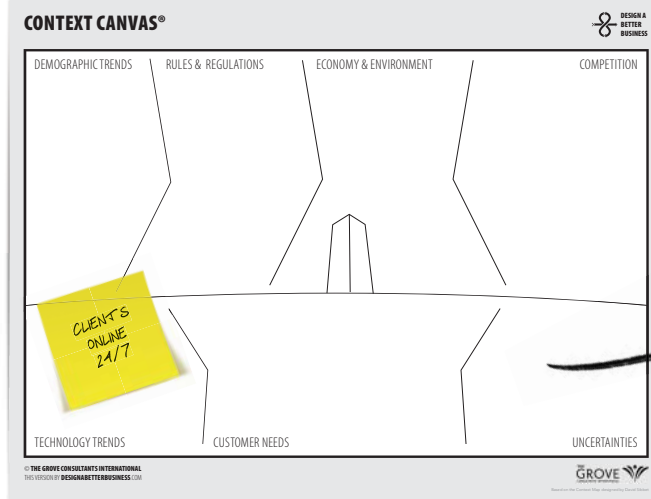


WHAT DID YOU
LEARN FROM YOUR
CUSTOMERS?

TAKE THE 5
MOST IMPORTANT
CRITERIA FROM THE
CONTEXT MAP.

WHAT CRITERIA COME
FROM STRENGTHS AND
WEAKNESSES OF YOUR
CURRENT BUSINESS
MODEL CANVAS?

Context
Canvas®
see
PAGE 110



FAIR
PRICES

PLAN
LANGUAGE

CLEAR
PRODUCTS

SIMPLE
PROCESSES

DESIGN CRITERIA CANVAS

MUST

CLEAR
AND
EASY

SHOULD

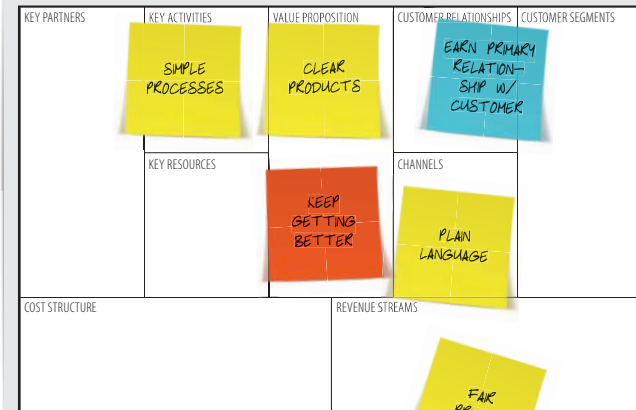
KEEP
GETTING
BETTER

COULD

WONT

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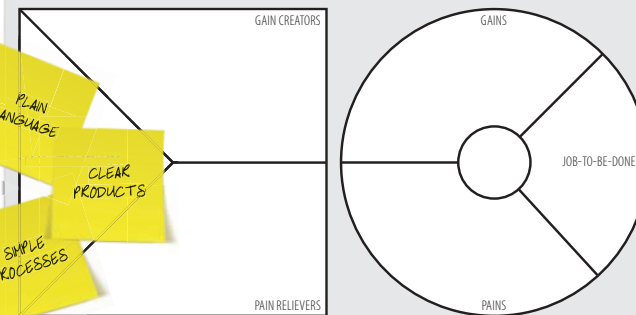
BUSINESS MODEL CANVAS



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VALUE PROPOSITION CANVAS



STRATEGYZER AG

Strategyzer

WHERE WILL THE DESIGN
CRITERIA SHOW UP? IN THE
BUSINESS MODEL? IN THE VALUE
PROPOSITION?

HOW DOES
THIS
TRANSLATE?

DESIGN CRITERIA WILL HELP
STRUCTURE BRAINSTORM SESSIONS AND
HELP YOU MAKE EDUCATED DECISIONS IN
YOUR DAILY JOB.



INTRO **STORYTELLING**

As humans, we tell stories every day. We use stories to explain, explore, engage, and persuade others. During the design journey, you will have many moments when you need to tell a good story. And, just like the other fundamentals of your strategy, good stories can be designed.

IT'S HUMAN NATURE

We are all born storytellers. Some of us make a living telling stories. Others have allowed their storytelling skills to be buried by work or school. The medium does not make storytelling nor can it be replaced by slides, emails, or spreadsheets. Though these tools can be used as canvases to tell a good story, you must first design the story you want to tell.

STORY

For as much as we're all born storytellers, however, not everyone can aspire to be the next Hemingway. But there are tricks to telling great stories! Stories can be designed. And here, we are talking about a broad category of storytelling, from person-to-person chats, to cool TED-style talks, to sales pitches, and even boardroom presentations. These are all stories.

SHARED KNOWLEDGE

Stories are how we have shared knowledge and information since the dawn of humanity. Our brains are shaped by storytelling. Today, stories are still the most powerful way to transfer ideas and beliefs. We live and breathe stories. Perhaps in our daily lives this may be

less obvious, but passing knowledge still is a vital skill in our survival toolbox.

ENGAGE

Neurological research shows that the same areas are activated in the brain of a listener as in the brain of the storyteller! Because stories engage emotions and other senses, the listener can "re-live" the moment and really learn from it. That is something numbers on a page can never do. In their popular book *Made to Stick*, Chip and Dan Heath make this point right up front when they recall the popular urban legend (i.e., story) about "the guy" who wakes up in a bathtub filled with ice only to find out that one of his kidneys has been harvested. Remember that one? The reason this engages us is that, as the Heath brothers point out, it's simple, unexpected, concrete, credible, and emotional.

DEATH BY POWERPOINT

So, if we're such natural storytellers, why do we still bore each other to death with PowerPoint? It's because most of us have never really learned how to design stories. Even in school, we were mostly instructed in academic writing and presentation, which is often

STORY WITH A BIG S

Story has played a significant role in all cultures but its adoption into professional cultures has been painfully slow. That's because it's easier to give a cut-and-dried report than a well-crafted presentation that incorporates stories.

I know "story" has become a buzzword, but that's just story with a little "s." What I'm talking about is story with a big "S": the art of communicating your ideas using a persuasive narrative structure. It's a story that has a beginning, middle, and end, and uses dramatic principles of tension and contrast to move your audience to a different state of thinking, feeling, and acting.

Nancy Duarte
Author, Principal at Duarte, Inc.

supposed to be an unemotional, objective, and efficient way of sharing information, rather than engaging.

THE STORYTELLING CANVAS

We created the Storytelling Canvas to make it easier to construct a story that people care to listen to. The PowerPoint presentations you give probably lack the emotional depth and impact you want to build in a story. However, the stories we design can be told through the medium of PowerPoint!

Like the other tools in this book, the story canvas allows you to collectively design stories that resonate: by harnessing visual, engaging, insightful, controlled, and inspiring elements. ■



For information
on presenting
visual stories,
read:
Resonate by
Nancy Duarte



TOOL STORYTELLING CANVAS

Created by Thirty-X



TANGIBLE

build a story



± 45 MIN

pressure cooker



3–5

people per group

What you'll need to understand when designing your story is that there must be a goal. What do you want your audience to know, feel, or do afterward? Your goal needs to be quite selective: you can make only a few points in your story!

YOUR AUDIENCE

In addition to knowing what you want to achieve, you need to understand who your audience is. What do they care about? Why should they listen to your story? Different audiences need different stories; one size does not fit all! You might even use the right side of the Value Proposition Canvas or a persona canvas to map the audience. Test your assumptions: while designing and telling the story, revisit your persona, and update it with what you learned.

BEFORE AND AFTER

In order to be meaningful, your story should change your audience in some way. Their beliefs, emotions, or knowledge should be transformed by the time you are finished.

How did your audience feel about your goal before they heard your story? Do they care about it now? What would you like them to think about once you're through? Trying to define it from the audience's perspective is key.

Try to come up with arguments that may change their minds, and make sure you have a list of rational, emotional, and ethical points. What is your "proof"? Do you have examples? Anecdotes? Find the ones that will resonate with your audience.

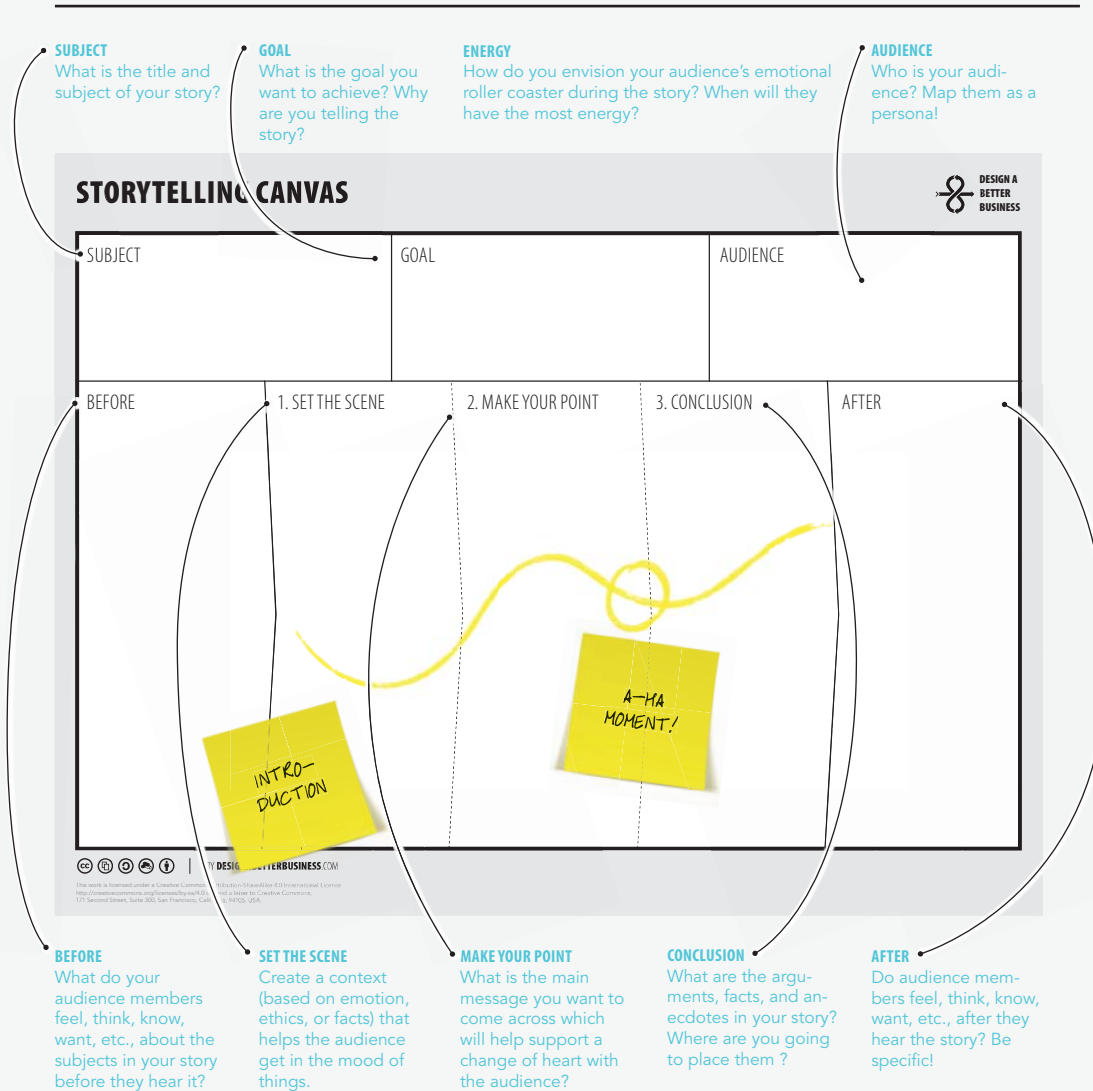
THE EMOTIONAL ROLLER COASTER

A good story is not a flat line; it has ups and downs. Now it's time to consider how you might design your own emotional roller coaster. Where is your climax moment? That is the moment you want to use to make your main point.

THREE ACTS

Like most good stories, the story canvas is divided into three parts: a beginning, a middle, and an end. The beginning is where you'll set the scene. The middle is where you'll put the meat of the story. And the end is where you'll want to leave your audience: in a new state of mind. Divide the arguments, examples, and anecdotes. And, for good measure, insert a bit of humor over the three acts. Now have a look at the emotional roller coaster again. Did you follow your idea? Or do you want to change it?

Another thing to consider while organizing the pieces of your story is to accommodate different styles of listening. Cater to the rational, organized listeners first; they want to get a clear picture of what you are talking about in order to decide whether they want to listen at all. But don't forget the others. Emotional listeners are more patient, but they do need emotion or they will get bored. Now that all this is filled in, you have the blueprint of your story. ■



DOWNLOAD
Download the Storytelling Canvas from www.designabetterbusiness.com

CHECKLIST

- ☐ You have a clear idea of what the audience thinks and feels.
- ☐ You have prepared clear arguments to make your point.
- ☐ You have one strong conclusion to end your story with.
- ☐ You know how to manage the energy during your story.
- ☐ You know the possible booby traps you may encounter and have a plan B.

NEXT STEPS

- > Test your story.
- > Make the visuals.
- > Experiment with the pace and energy.

TOOL TELLING THE VISUAL STORY OF AUDI

A team at Audi needed to obtain buy-in within the company to move forward with an idea for the future. The car world is changing rapidly, and it was necessary to convince the company quickly. This was an important story to tell. Here's how they approached it.

STRONG
BRAND

STORYTELLING CANVAS

DESIGN A BETTER BUSINESS

SUBJECT	THE FUTURE OF TRANSPORTATION	GOAL	GET THEM ONBOARD	AUDIENCE	COMPANY LEADERSHIP
BEFORE	1. SET THE SCENE			3. CONCLUSION	
BUSINESS AS USUAL		DRONES	PRIVATE LIFE IN- AND OUTSIDE CAR	OPTIONS EXIST OUTSIDE THE CAR	
MORE CARS ON THE ROAD		EMERGING TECH	FREEDOM OF CHOICE	INVEST IN NEW IDEAS	
		SELF-DRIVING CARS			

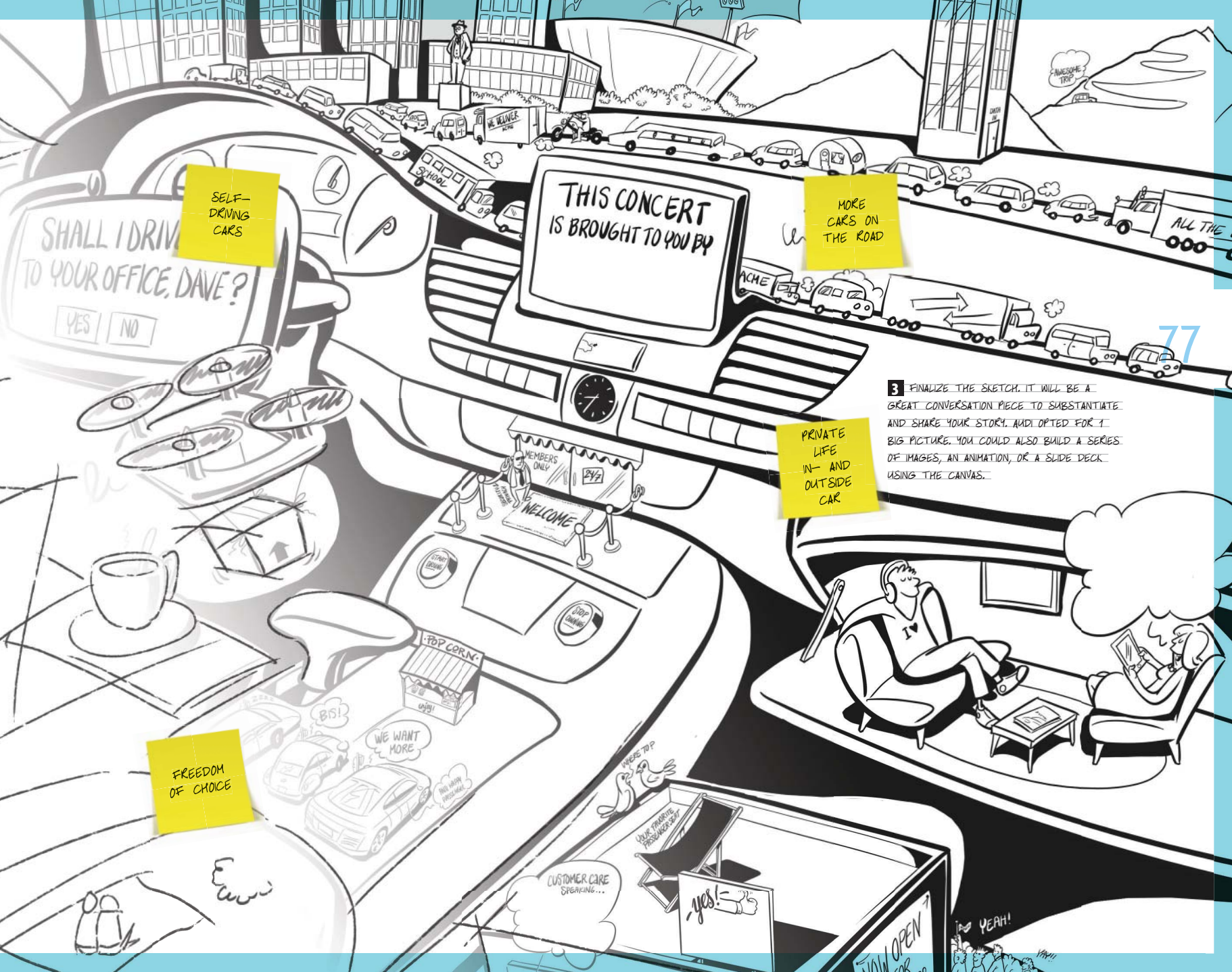
1 FILL IN THE CANVAS AS DESCRIBED ON PAGES 74-75. MAKE SURE YOU COVER ALL AREAS.

2 SIT TOGETHER WITH VISUAL ARTIST TO PLOT THE STICKY NOTES FROM THE CANVAS ON A (BIG) PIECE OF PAPER. MAKE A FIRST SKETCH. ARE ALL THE BUILDING BLOCKS THERE? IS IT THE RIGHT LOOK AND FEEL?

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STORYTELLING HACKS

THE A-HA MOMENT

The audience's a-ha moment is something they have to create for themselves. It needs to occur as a spark in their brains. Think of it as a joke. You can set it up and make the joke, but over-explain it and nobody will laugh. Your main point should be an a-ha moment. Don't try to over-explain it.

WARNING! If you are pitching to an investor, the customers of your product are not necessarily the audience of your story. Your investor has a totally different set of needs than your customers.

USE SPEAKER NOTES

When you are telling a story in public, use speaker notes. That way, you don't have to tell the story exactly as it appears on the slides – and you'll appear more natural.

TRYOUTS

Standup comedians do multiple tryouts to make their act a success. And a tryout is not the same thing as rehearsing the story in a mirror. That is just the first step.

Find some actual people to listen to your story. See when they are engaged and when they get confused. When do you lose their interest?

USE PROPS

Just as you'll need to accommodate different listening styles, you'll also need to take into account the differing ways your audience absorbs information. Some people are more visually oriented than others. Props will help hammer home your points while providing them with something to relate to.

THE END IS REALLY THE END

When you finish the story, really finish it. Staying on stage and continuing to talk about unrelated things confuses your audience. Think about this: they will remember the last thing you say. What will that be?



HAVE A PLAN B

Telling a story can be scary, and it won't always go as planned. Come up with a few "plan B" actions beforehand that you can use when a point does not come across. Use the rescue cards to plan ahead!

THINKING YOU'RE THE STAR

When you are telling the story, you're not telling it for you. You're telling it for the audience. Make sure they are the star of the story.

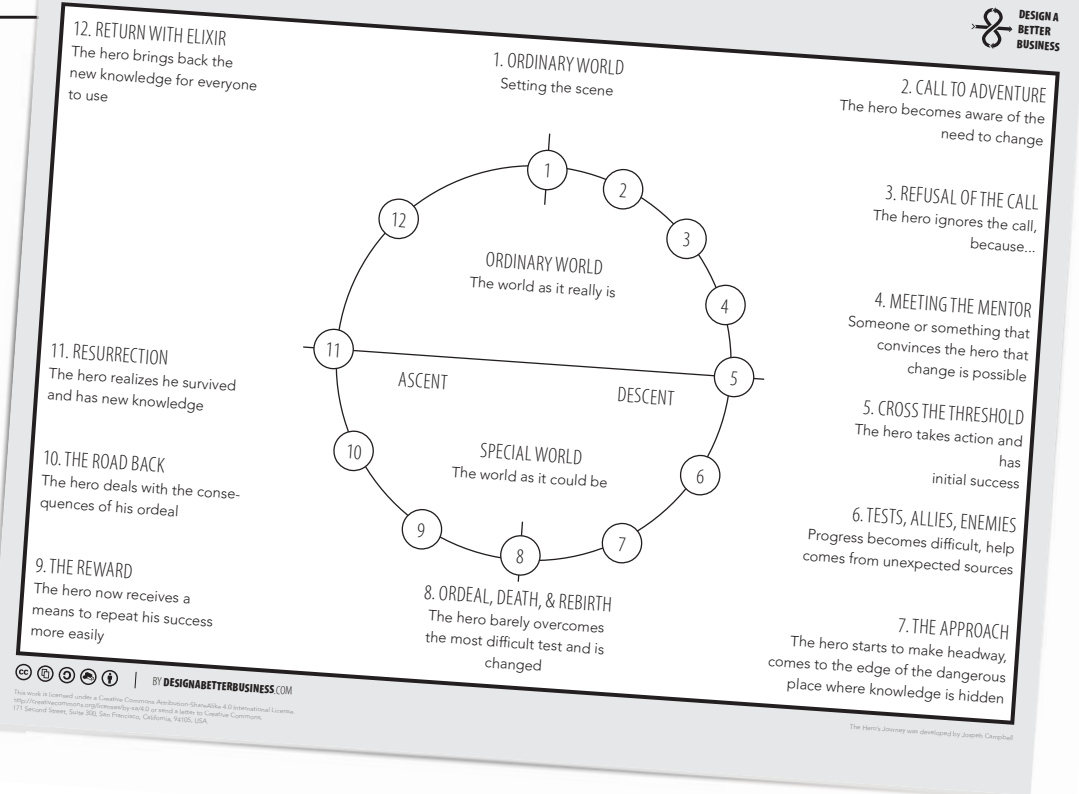
CULTURAL REFERENCE

If you speak to a different audience, and certainly if you tell your story in a different culture, you're in for a shock. The examples and jokes that worked so well before may not resonate at all. Using American football metaphors in Europe doesn't work. And just try talking about cricket outside of the Commonwealth . . . Test your stories before you tell them!

HERO'S JOURNEY CANVAS

Every movie hero's fate follows a certain path: everything starts out fine, and then he encounters a

HERO'S JOURNEY CANVAS



great setback – usually in the middle of the movie.

This historical way of telling a (hero) story is a perfect guideline to follow. Use the Hero's Journey Canvas to plot all the building blocks. ■



DOWNLOAD

Download the Hero's Journey Canvas from www.designabetterbusiness.com



For more background, read:
The Hero with a Thousand Faces
by Joseph Campbell

YOU NOW HAVE . . .

- DRAFTED YOUR VISION
AS **A RALLYING CRY** P58
- YOUR FIRST SET OF
DESIGN CRITERIA P68
- DESIGNED YOUR STORY TO
CREATE IMPACT P74

NEXT STEPS

- **OBSERVE & QUESTION** P88
Meet (potential) customers.
- **GO OUT OF THE BUILDING** P102
and test your assumptions
on vision.
- **UNDERSTAND YOUR VALUE** P106
How do you currently add value
for your customers?
- **UNDERSTAND YOUR CONTEXT** P110
What is the context you currently
(want to) operate in?

RECAP

BE **A REBEL.**

**A VISION IS A RALLYING
CRY** FOR YOU AND YOUR TEAM.

A VISION **IS NOT** A VISION
STATEMENT.

DESIGN CRITERIA ARE THE
BENCHMARKS OF CHANGE.

USE STORYTELLING TO **INSPIRE
AND SCALE.**
